

ANDROMEDA JONES

THE ULTIMATE ESL VOCABULARY MANUAL

phrasal
verbs

business
speak

expressions



The Ultimate ESL Vocabulary Manual

By Andromeda Jones

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Introduction

When I wrote The Ultimate ESL Teaching Manual in 2016, I added a 20-page vocabulary section at the back of the book. My aim was to provide ESL teachers with a resource on all basic vocabulary topics so then they don't have to waste valuable lesson-prep time searching for words on the internet.

For many years, these vocabulary lists have sufficed. I was teaching English at an academy and found that students (even at higher levels) rarely needed, and indeed never asked for, vocabulary outside the scope of the book.

It was only when I started teaching Business English online that I realised I had to go deeper. My online students spend at least part of their working lives speaking, reading and listening to English. They already know the basic vocabulary found in text-books.

Instead, they read and hear phrases like '*a win-win*', '*a game-changer*', '*a setback*' or '*to get back on track*.' They know that there is a whole subsection of English spoken by natives in the 21st century and they want to learn it.

A major frustration among second language English speakers is that they feel robotic when they speak; as though they're performing a series of language functions rather than making a real impression.

In contrast, native speakers communicate effortlessly. They influence colleagues with a witty anecdote or an impassioned speech. They win debates using inventive, trendy words, bending the language to their will.

In these cases, second language speakers can only watch helplessly from the side-lines while native speakers dominate meetings, conferences and social situations.

Second language speakers are tired of being on the outside of the native English club. They want to learn *real* English as it is used in its different varieties in homes, workplaces and the internet in the 21st century.

But with standard text-books, the club remains locked. Enter a new generation of brilliant ESL teachers to open the door and guide the way.

Vocabulary that will set you apart from other ESL teachers

To help students feel like themselves when conversing in English, I knew that I had to update the vocabulary that I taught. I had to go beyond the obvious words and include more expressions and phrasal verbs, as well as modern words such as new compound nouns and adjectives, created in just the last few decades. Let's look at each one in more detail.

Expressions

English speakers often use words to convey detail while they use expressions to convey an emotion. Let's look at an example:

Speaker one says: *'My daughter got a high mark in her final exams.'*
Speaker two says: *'My daughter passed her finals with flying colours'* or *'She aced her exams!'*

Which speaker made the listener smile and really conveyed the triumph of their daughter's achievements? Speaker two, of course.

An expression delivers greater emotional power. The listener takes in and remembers what was said. This is why native speakers so often favour expressions over verbs.

To ignore the teaching of expressions is to ignore a fundamental reason for communication; to create an impact. Without a set of expressions in their language toolkit, your student will always be that person at a party who seems nice but can't hold their listener's attention because nothing they say really makes an impression. You'll find plenty of expressions to teach your students in this book. For a list of expressions, go to Business speak in Chapter 5; Emotions and behaviours in Chapter 10 and Social interactions in Chapter 11.

Phrasal verbs

In my experience, most students of a B1-level or above are interested in learning some phrasal verbs. Instead, it is ESL teachers themselves who are reluctant to teach them because it just seems so *impossible*. How do you teach 'take on', 'take off', 'take up', 'take down' and 'take over' so that your students can remember and use them? The answer is with great difficulty.

And yet, we use phrasal verbs for practically everything and so if a teacher doesn't teach phrasal verbs, then their students won't understand conversations with native speakers.

Moreover, have you ever asked yourself why – given that phrasal verbs are so perplexing – we use them so much? The reason for this is that phrasal verbs enrich English by dividing and subdividing meaning down to the finest detail.

For example, if you say that '*Simon didn't attend a meeting,*' the meaning is ambiguous. Was it that Simon was expected at the meeting but didn't attend? Or was it that he wasn't needed at the meeting and so didn't go? Or perhaps Simon was scheduled to attend the meeting but suddenly found his invitation rescinded? From this sentence, you simply don't know.

Now substitute the words '*didn't attend*' for '*didn't show up*' and you have a much clearer picture. This is the power of phrasal verbs. In one short sentence, the speaker expresses the nitty-gritty of what they are saying without further clarification (Simon was expected at the meeting but he didn't come!).

Teach phrasal verbs effectively with a new technique

Most ESL students understand the importance of phrasal verbs and are eager to learn. The problem is, how do you teach them? Well, this book presents a new technique; teaching phrasal verbs by the preposition and not the verb. Each preposition has one or several meanings. By teaching each meaning, you help your students to crack the code of phrasal verbs, allowing them to decipher the denotation of new verbs without being told. It's a powerful skill. Learn more about it in Chapter two; How to teach phrasal verbs.

Compound nouns and adjectives

Finally, on to compound nouns and adjectives. As new inventions and ideas arise in the human consciousness, we naturally invent new words for them. We don't create these words from thin air. Rather, we take two existing words and put them together to create a new meaning. An example of this is '*electronic mail*' from the words '*mail*' to signify a messaging service and '*electronic*' because this type of mail is composed of electronic data. Over

time, these words were pushed together to produce a new word: ‘*email*.’

All languages seem to do this but none, it seems, more so than English. New hybrid words are constantly birthed in our language. Sometimes they have a hyphen such as ‘*time-consuming*’ or ‘*no-brainer*’ and sometimes without, such as ‘*outcome*’, ‘*dealbreaker*’ or ‘*deadline*.’

The native speaking ability to create new words ‘off-the-cuff’ when needed is part of the reason why English is the language of our modern, globalised world. Only our free-spirited English, it seems, has the ability to keep up with the relentless pace of ever-changing technology, ideas and business-systems. This is why teaching hybrid newly-invented words is essential for your students’ ability to communicate. You can find a comprehensive list of compound nouns and adjectives in Chapter 5 - Business speak.

How this book is designed

The chapters in this book have been divided into 21st century life functions and aspirations such as ‘Personal development’, ‘Work tasks’, ‘Free time’ and ‘Socialising’.

At the beginning of each section, you’ll find a task to activate the students’ passive vocabulary by brainstorming basic vocabulary on a particular language point (see Chapter one -- Techniques for teaching vocabulary).

After the basics, teachers can go deeper into the subject with the advanced vocabulary below. The final section called ‘The good stuff’ contains conversational terms and phrases on the topic. It is named as such because this is the moment when the students will prick their ears and smile as they realise that these are the nuggets of information that will help them speak like a native.

Finally, each section contains conversation starter questions to help your students practice the vocabulary in class.

Who will not benefit (so much) from these vocabulary sets?

These vocabulary sets are designed for intermediate students up to C2 proficient level. As such, they do not contain very basic lexical sets such as clothes, animals, food and house vocabulary taught at the lower levels.

These lexical sets are probably too advanced for pre-teens unless they are a very high level. They can be used from teen-level onwards.

It is intermediate to advanced students, business students, adults and teens who will benefit the most from these vocabulary sets.

Finally

English is a vibrant, creative language that changes by the year. Teach it in the way that it is really spoken in the modern age. When it comes to selecting what to teach, ask yourself - what would *I* want to learn?

Trust your instincts and happy teaching!

1. Techniques to teach vocabulary

Vocabulary isn't a separate language discipline. Rather, the absorption of new words is intertwined with all aspects of learning a language.

As such, in addition to teaching words, ESL teachers should present opportunities for the students to discover new vocabulary for themselves.

This happens most effectively through homework activities. ESL teachers should give intermediate students and above a podcast or video to listen to or an article to read, ideally after each class. The associated task is asking the students to note down any new vocabulary.

This material serves as part of speaking practice as your students discuss the material in the following class. As part of the discussion, the teacher should ask the students to share any new words that they have learned and explain the meaning.

In this way, new vocabulary is more likely to stick as a) the students learned the word organically as part of the material rather than as part of a vocabulary set and b) they have experienced the word in its natural context and so have a greater chance of understanding its meaning.

Real-world materials for learning English

Sadly, most quality US and UK newspapers have put up paywalls but there are other resources on the internet where you can find interesting material. Some of my favourites are:

BBC 6 Minute English Podcast – short ESL podcasts about everyday topics.

TED Talks – presentations on a variety of topics including science and tech.

TED ED Talks – short animations on science, art, history, literature and more.

Wired magazine – articles on technology and business issues.

The Guardian newspaper – a UK quality newspaper.

BBC News – news from the UK and around the world.

INC – a US business magazine.

How to teach vocabulary in the classroom

Accumulating vocabulary organically takes time and so naturally, students will want to engage with vocabulary as part of their English programme. But how do you teach vocabulary and which words are useful?

Activating passive language

It is not always evident but most students have at least some vocabulary stored from their years of exposure to English. This could be from school, TV, advertising and even song lyrics.

Therefore before teaching a new language point, do a brainstorming session with your class to see what words they already know.

To do this, write the language topic in a circle on the blackboard, for example ‘money’, and add words around it as your class brainstorms all of the words and phrases that they know associated with it.

Once you’ve activated this passive vocabulary, the teacher should fill in any gaps from their own vocabulary list.

Synonyms

Another way to activate passive vocabulary is to give the student a word and ask them to tell you a synonym.

For example, when teaching adjectives, the teacher could write the most commonly used adjective on the blackboard and ask the class to think of some synonyms. For example:

Teacher: Angry.

Student: Furious.

Ask for an example

After each new word, a teacher should always ask for several examples from the class to check that they understand the meaning. In addition, the teacher should ask the students to write something using the new vocabulary to put it into a context that works for them.

Seeding conversations

There are highly-successful ESL teachers out there who never ‘teach’ vocabulary. Rather, they brilliantly introduce new vocabulary during the conversation practice part of their sessions. I call this technique ‘seeding’ because the teacher ‘sows’ the new vocabulary in their students’ minds through verbal interactions, much like mothers do for their children.

This technique only really works for one-to-one classes or small groups where the students have a lot of teacher attention. Advanced students particularly appreciate this technique as it is a way to learn more unusual ESL vocabulary quickly as the conversations give the students the opportunity to both practice and understand the meaning of the word through the context.

Great teachers have a list of phrasal verbs, phrases, compound nouns and adjectives on hand to thread into conversations with advanced students. You’ll find a list of these words and phrases in Chapter two; How to teach phrasal verbs, Chapter five; Business vocabulary, Chapter 10 - Emotions and behaviours and finally, Chapter 11 - Social interactions.

Speaking practice

Language doesn’t come alive unless your students have the opportunity to speak it. Reinforce the words by getting your students to practice them through speaking activities.

Ways to practice targeted vocabulary in your lessons

Here are some different methods to practice vocabulary in your lessons.

The ‘use all the words’ game

Divide your students into pairs for speaking practice. Ask each person to write 10 or so words that they wish to practice on a piece of paper. Next, start your pairs’ speaking practice. This could be asking and answering questions or telling a story. Challenge your students to use every word on the list, crossing them off each time. The winner is the first student to use all of their words in their speech in the right context.

Explain all of the steps

Ask your students to use all of the words they can on a topic by explaining all of the steps to complete a task.

For example, for travel vocabulary, your student could explain the steps to going on holiday, from booking your flights to arriving at your destination. For money vocabulary, they could explain the steps to taking out a loan from setting up a bank account to signing the loan agreement.

A word about role-plays

In my experience, role-plays are better for practising grammar points rather than vocabulary as it is too easy to ignore the new words. In addition, as role-plays require people to ‘perform’, they are not always popular among students – particularly business students learning English in their place of work.

If you do use a role-play to practice vocabulary, make it as close as possible to an experience that the student is likely to encounter such as ordering food, complaining at a restaurant, asking for directions or taking out a loan.

Reinforcing what a student has learned after class

In order for new vocabulary to become ‘real’ in a student’s mind, they need to see and hear it in context. This could be in the context of materials produced by others such as articles or videos or in their own context with materials that they have written themselves.

Aside from the podcast, video and articles, here are some other great ways that students can understand vocabulary in their natural context.

Youghlish

Youghlish uses YouTube to teach the pronunciation and meaning of any English word. Write a word or phrase into the search bar and Youghlish will bring up a snippet of a video with someone using it. It is a great tool with which to develop a student’s understanding of difficult words such as phrasal verbs as it shows people using the vocabulary in a natural context.

Dictionaries and Wikipedia

Type any word into Google and a page of popular dictionary sites will pop up to explain the meaning. As each dictionary includes their own example sentences, they provide a valuable resource when determining the correct usage of a word. In recent years, Wikipedia has become a word resource too with many phrasal verbs given their own page.

Writing

To be able to use a word, your student must understand it through their own life context. A great way to do this is through writing sentences. For example, if it is a business word such as ‘*to take on a project*’, your student should think about how they would use this word to describe their own activities and write an example as part of a dialogue or sentence.

Translations

Connecting English to the student’s mother-tongue is imperative for understanding. Online translation sites like Word Reference, which translate

the meaning of a phrase rather than word-for-word, will give your students a richer understanding of English.

When your students look confused, ask them what they think a verb or phrase is in their language. They don't have to reveal the answer but it's important for them to work the problem through themselves.

What words should I teach?

You can't teach every word in the English language nor should you try. Native speakers of every language have a relatively small active vocabulary and a much larger passive vocabulary which they use only in certain circumstances (such as explaining something technical).

By C1 advanced stage, your students should have about 80% of a native speaker's active vocabulary, covering their daily experiences and the environment in which they live.

The Ultimate ESL Vocabulary Manual is a curated list of words designed to express the breadth of the human experience but it's just the starting point. As a professional ESL teacher, it's your job to distil and tailor the material so then your students can grab the words that they need with ease and use them to express their true personality, opinions and feelings.

2. How to teach phrasal verbs

New phrasal verbs such as ‘man up’ and ‘wind down’ are being added to the dictionary every year. Have you ever wondered why it is that native speakers instantly know what they mean without being told? The reason is that we understand the meaning from the preposition.

Most phrasal verbs carry a preposition or particle which relates to the meaning of the verb. For example, one of the meanings of ‘on’ is ‘to attach.’ From this idea, we have the verbs, ‘to put on’ and ‘to try on’ meaning to attach clothes to your body.

Note: There are some common phrasal verbs that exist outside of this rule. For example, ‘to take up’ and ‘to make up.’ However, the meaning of most phrasal verbs bears a close relation to the preposition.

Teaching phrasal verbs by preposition

Introduce the meanings of each preposition little-by-little with gaps between your phrasal verb classes while you focus on something else. Start with an easy preposition that only has only one meaning such as ‘back’.

Explain that ‘back’ means ‘to return’ and ask your students to brainstorm all the phrasal verbs that they can which contain this word such as ‘give back’, ‘take back’ and ‘pay back.’ Your students will quickly come to realise that these verbs are simply a variant on *‘the way in which something is returned.’*

To make this point clear, ask your students how they would express each of these meanings in their own language. Would they use a separate verb, the same verb or another word combination? Connecting unfamiliar words and phrases to their own language is an important part of naturalising English in a student’s mind.

Once your students are confident using prepositions with only one meaning, move on to other common (but more complicated) prepositions that have two or more meanings such as ‘on’, ‘off’, ‘up’, ‘down’ and ‘out.’

Each time you introduce a new phrasal verb, ask your students to give you an example to check that they understand the meaning.

To commit phrasal verbs to memory, your students also need to do a significant amount of work themselves such as writing sentences, searching for real-life examples on Youglish or in articles and making an effort to use them in conversation.

The following phrasal verbs have been divided by preposition. Many of these verbs can be found later in the book as part of the vocabulary sets.

Phrasal verbs divided by preposition

Phrasal verbs with ‘back’

Meaning: to return

To come back – to return (from the perspective of the people you are returning to).

‘Simon called his wife and told her that he was coming back home at 5 pm.’

To get back – to return a phone call or other communication.

‘She’ll get back to you tomorrow.’

To go back – to return (from the perspective of the people you are leaving).

‘Simon told his boss that he had finished his work and he was going back home.’

To give back – to return something that was given.

To move back – to return to your place of origin by moving there.

To put back – to return something that was purposely put in a certain place.

To pay back – to return money by paying.

To take back – to return something that was bought (taken from a shop).

Advanced

To get back on track – to return to the “path of success.”

‘I took a break from my diet over Christmas but now it’s the new year, I am getting myself back on track.’

Phrasal verbs with 'on'

Meaning one: to attach

To put on – to attach clothes to your body.

'I can't take on any more work. I have too much already.'

To get on with someone – to attach yourself to a person for friendship (to like someone as friends).

'I get on well with my neighbour.'

To get on + bus, train, plane, boat – to attach yourself to a vehicle.

'He got on the plane at 9am and it took off at 9.30am.'

To take on – to attach a new employee to a company or to attach more work or responsibility to an individual.

To try on – to attach clothes to your body to try them.

To turn on/ to switch on – to attach device to a power source.

Advanced

To catch on – a new idea or fashion attaches itself to a society.

'The idea of legalising gay marriage is catching on in the Western world.'

Meaning two: to continue

To carry on + gerund/ to carry on with + noun – to continue an activity.

To go on – to continue speaking or continue moving.

To keep on – to continue with an action.

To move on – to continue to another topic or another phase in one's life.

'OK, we've finished with the accounts. Let's move on to talk about the marketing budget.'

To play on – to continue playing after the referee has paused the match.

To soldier on– to continue with your daily activities despite feeling unwell or unhappy about something.

‘My husband has a terrible cold but he’s soldiering on.’

Phrasal verbs with 'off'

Meaning one: to detach

To call off – to cancel a meeting or event (detach yourself from the meeting or event by calling people about it).

'They called off the wedding at the last moment.'

To get off + bus, train, plane, boat – to detach yourself from a vehicle.

To put off – to postpone (to temporarily detach yourself from a responsibility you have to do.)

'I have put off taking that exam until next year.'

To take off – to detach clothes.

To take off – when a plane detaches itself from the ground.

To turn off / to switch off – to detach a device from a power source.

Advanced

To go off – to explode. The trigger in a bomb detaches itself and the bomb explodes.

'The bomb went off in the town square. It was a terrible tragedy.'

To drop off – to take someone somewhere by car and leave them there (to detach them from your car).

'Can you drop me off at the station?'

Meaning two: to leave

To be off – to tell someone you're leaving or to comment that someone else is leaving.

'Are you off already? The party has only just started.'

To drive off – to leave by driving.

‘The truck drove off into the night.’

To run off – to leave by running.

‘Don’t run off and leave me here with all of these bags.’

To walk off – to leave by walking or to abandon.

‘The man walked off and left his kids in the park.’

Advanced

To set off – to start a journey (to leave your place of origin to begin a journey).

‘They set off for the mountain early.’

To head off – to leave, going towards a new place.

‘Where is John?’ ‘I saw him earlier, heading off into town.’

Phrasal verbs with ‘up’

Meaning one: to emphasise the verb

If you say, ‘*Eat up your food!*’, what you’re really saying is ‘*Eat all of your food*’ or ‘*Eat and eat your food until it is all finished.*’ In this way, the phrasal verb has the same meaning as the original verb; the ‘up’ provides emphasis.

To book up /to be booked up – the hospitality establishment is full to capacity.

To clean up – to clean when something is very messy.

To clear up/ to tidy up – to put a place in order.

To eat up – to eat everything on your plate.

To face up to something – to confront something.

To free up – to liberate time or space.

‘Computers free up a lot of time.’

To fix up – to fix something to a high standard.

To listen up – to listen with attention.

‘Listen up people; we need to rebuild the library.’

To mix up – to mix vigorously or to get confused.

To read up on – to do a lot of reading about a subject.

‘We visited Egypt and so I did a lot of reading up on the ancient Egyptians before we left.’

To use up – to use completely.

‘We have to use up all of the milk in the fridge before it goes off.’

To save up for – to save money for something in particular.

‘He’s saving up for a new bike.’

Advanced

To buy up – to buy everything in a shop.

‘There was an offer for toilet paper and so Dad bought up all of the toilet paper in the shop.’

To cheer up – to animate someone.

‘We are taking him out to cheer him up after he didn’t get the job.’

To cut up – to completely destroy something through cutting.

‘He cut up his t-shirt.’

Meaning two: to increase

To turn up – to increase the volume of a speaker.

‘They turned up the music to maximum until the neighbours complained.’

To speak up – to speak louder.

‘Speak up please; my grandmother is a little deaf.’

To speed up – to increase speed.

‘Speed up. It’s a 50 kpm limit here.’

To warm up – to increase your body heat before exercise.

Meaning three: to make a distinction

If a verb has more than one meaning, English speakers often make a distinction by adding ‘up’ at the end.

To teach this point, give your students two verbs such as ‘to break’ and ‘to break up’ and ask them what they think the difference is.

To bring up – to introduce a subject.

To build up – to accumulate.

‘We are building up our list of contacts.’

To break up/ to split up – to end a relationship.

To catch up – to do tasks that should have been done earlier/ to reach someone ahead of you.

To chase up – to pursue information or work that you expect to be completed.

‘I need to chase up an answer from the sales team.’

To do up – to refurbish or renovate.

To end up – to end in an unexpected way.

‘I made the cake for my colleagues but I ended up eating it myself.’

To follow up – to continue a meeting with another action.

‘I will follow this up with an email next week.’

To grow up – when a baby turns into an adult.

To keep up – to maintain the rhythm or pace.

‘I can’t keep up when people speak fast in French.’

To set up – to configure, organise or start a business.

Advanced

To mess up – to make a mistake.

‘I just messed up the project. Sorry!’

To do up – to fasten a piece of clothing or a seatbelt.

‘Do up your seatbelt please, we’re about to leave.’

To dress up – to dress in a costume or put your best clothes on.

‘It is customary to dress up in a scary costume for Halloween.’

Phrasal verbs with ‘down’

Meaning one: to reduce something

To calm down – to reduce your stress.

‘You’ve had a stressful day. Have a cup of tea to calm down.’

To cut down on – to reduce the amount of something that you eat, drink or smoke.

‘I’m cutting down on sugar.’

To cool down – to reduce your heat.

‘After working out at the gym, it is important to take a moment to cool down.’

To settle down – to reduce your movement.

To slow down – to reduce your speed.

To turn down – to reduce the volume of something.

‘Turn down that music!’

Advanced

To come down to – to reduce an argument to its basic point. This is often related to money.

‘The fate of the project came down to how much the stakeholders were willing to invest.’

To turn down – to reduce your options by rejecting something.

‘He turned down the job offer.’

To let down – to disappoint (to reduce your expectations).

‘She felt let down when her parents didn’t come to see her in the play.’

Meaning two: to remove something that is higher, wider or

above you

To blow down – when something large (like a house or tree) collapses due to a strong wind.

To burn down – when something larger than a person is destroyed in a fire.

To cut down – to cut something that is higher or wider than you (such as a tree or a hedge).

To knock down – to deliberately make a building (or part of it) fall using a wrecking ball or other tools.

‘The government are knocking down derelict buildings.’

To shoot down – to shoot something higher than you such as a bird or plane with the intention of bringing it down to the ground.

To take down – to remove something higher than you.

Meaning three: to temporarily break something

‘Down’ on its own means a temporary breakage. For example: *‘The communications network is down,’* or *‘the coverage is down at the moment, so I can’t call you.’* This idea is found in other languages like Spanish where the temporary breakage or stoppage of a network would be described as ‘bajo/a’ (‘down’). Incidentally, when something is fixed, we use the preposition ‘up’ to say that something is *‘back up and running.’*

To break down – a large machine like a car, plane or boat temporarily breaks.

‘My car broke down on the motorway.’

Phrasal verbs with ‘out’

Meaning one: to exit

To break out (of prison) – to exit by breaking.

‘It took the protagonist in the Shawshank Redemption 25 years to break out of prison.’

To fall out – to exit by falling.

To get out – to exit a small space that you can’t move in like a car, shower, elevator or bed.

To take out – to take something outside, to withdraw money or to shoot someone in a video game (exiting them from a video game).

‘Can you take out the rubbish please?’

‘How much money are you going to take out the bank to buy the car?’

‘I just took out that guy in the rabbit costume in Fortnite. Now there are only three of us left.’

To sell out – all of the products exit the shop by being sold.

To move out – to move house or apartment (to exit the house or apartment by moving).

Advanced

To buy out – to exit a business by allowing someone else to buy it completely.

‘My uncle owns a grocery store but he let a big supermarket buy out his business.’

To get out –to tell someone to leave in a rude way.

‘Get out of my office! You’re fired!’

To pop out –to exit somewhere quickly and then return.

'I am just popping out to buy some bread. Does anyone else want to come?'

Meaning two: to complete/ to solve

To fill out a form.

'How many forms do I have to fill out to get my VISA?'

To sort out – to organise, arrange or fix something.

'We have to sort out a new router for the WIFI.'

To work out – to solve a problem.

'We'll work out how to fix the program later.'

To figure out – to understand what something is and to try to solve it (to decipher something).

'Sherlock Holmes is good at figuring out who committed the crime.'

Meaning three: to search for something out of immediate experience

Imagine that you are sitting in the middle of a circle. The circle represents your expertise or what you know on a particular day. It could also be how far you can see or hear something. The thing that you are trying to find, see or hear is *outside* of this circle and so you have to go out the circle to capture/discover it.

To find out about – to look for information outside of your immediate knowledge.

'I don't know what time the train leaves but I will find out.'

Advanced

To make out – to capture sound or a visual which is outside of your normal range for these senses.

'I can't make out what she was saying. She was too far away.'

To set out – to try to achieve something that has never been done before (outside of your previous knowledge).

‘NASA set out to land on the moon by the end of the 60s.’

‘She set out to reorder all of the books in the National Library. The job took her 6 months!’

Meaning four: to hide something or to keep something from getting close to you

To cross out – to hide a line of writing by drawing a line through it.

‘I have crossed out many things on my to-do list today!’

To keep out – to maintain something outside of a perimeter.

‘The sign says “Keep Out” so we shouldn’t enter.’

To block out – to keep an idea out of your mind.

‘She has blocked out the car accident. She doesn’t remember anything.’

Meaning five: to extinguish or to lose enthusiasm for something

To put out a fire – to extinguish a fire.

‘It took the fire-fighters a week to put out the forest fire.’

To fall out of love – when the enthusiasm dies in a romantic relationship.

To run out of something – to temporarily finish something so then you have to buy/obtain more.

‘My mobile battery is running out. I need to charge it.’

Advanced

To fizzle out – something that you started with lots of energy is now ‘dying’.

‘The party was great until 11pm and then it fizzled out.’

To die out – to become extinct.

‘How did the dinosaurs die out?’ ‘I don’t know – look it up on Google!’

Phrasal verbs with ‘in’

Meaning one: to enter

To break in – to enter by breaking something.

‘The thief broke into the museum.’

To move in – to enter an apartment or house by moving into it.

To get in something – to enter a small space where you can’t move around like a car, shower, elevator or bed.

‘Get in the car please, it is about to rain.’

Advanced

To get into something – to start a passion or hobby (to enter a passion or hobby).

‘He got into jazz music in his 20s.’

To pop in – to quickly go into a shop or house to buy or get something and then come out again.

‘I’m just popping into this shop to buy some milk. Do you want anything?’

Meaning two: to investigate

To look into something – to investigate.

‘We’re looking into your car insurance claim now.’

Phrasal verbs with ‘away’

Meaning: the method in which you leave

To back away – to leave but backwards (facing the person you’re leaving).

‘They backed away from the thief because he had a knife.’

To break away – small rocks break away from larger rocks as part of the natural process of erosion.

To drive away – to leave by driving.

‘The taxi left her at the station and drove away into the night.’

To give away – to allow something to leave your possession because you donate it for free.

‘They are giving away free tomatoes at the market because they have too many. Let’s go and get some.’

To move away – to leave by moving.

‘My best friend moved away to another province and now I barely see him.’

To run away – to flee.

‘The people ran away from the earthquake.’

To sail away – to leave by sailing on a boat.

‘All I want to do is to sail away into the distance on a beautiful yacht.’

To throw away – to throw trash into a bin. (It can also be used figuratively such as *‘to throw away an opportunity.’*)

To walk away – to leave by walking (also figurative: ‘he walked away from the marriage.’)

‘The ex-boyfriend and girlfriend hugged each other and walked away.’

Advanced

To break away – to leave by separating yourself from a bigger entity.

‘The politicians broke away from the main party and formed a new party.’

To drive away – to make someone or something else flee because of an action.

‘Stop shouting in the kitchen. You’re driving away the diners!’

To get away with something – to do something with impunity.

‘My sister never does her homework but our parents don’t notice. She always gets away with it.’

To get away – to go on holiday (to escape your normal life).

‘I’m so stressed. I need to get away.’ Also, ‘The get-away driver’ in a robbery.

To scare away – something leaves because it is scared.

‘The dog scared the birds away’.

To sneak away – to leave by stealth.

‘She sneaked away from the meeting.’

Phrasal verbs with ‘about’ and ‘around’

Meaning: to do something with no particular purpose

To go around – to travel (walk, drive or cycle) without a direction.

‘I’ve been going around the mall all morning.’

To hang about/around – to pass time with your friends doing nothing.

‘There are those teenagers again, hanging about in the park.’

To mess about/ around – to do silly things with no purpose.

‘Stop messing about and do some work!’

To run about/around – to run from place to place.

‘I’ve been running about all day!’

To walk about/around – to walk in a place with no purpose.

‘We walked around Paris all day. It was great!’

To wander about/around – to walk in a place with no direction, looking at the sights.

‘They spent all week wandering about London. They got lost but it was lots of fun.’

Advanced (different meaning)

To get round to + gerund – to find enough time to do something.

‘I will get around to calling my mother later.’ (It’s on the list but I have to postpone arriving at the task until later.)

Phrasal verbs with ‘over’

Meaning one: To pass above, through or on something

To run over – to pass above something in a car, causing them terrible harm.

‘The car ran over the cat and killed it.’

To get over – to recover (to pass through an illness or bad situation and come out the other side).

‘It took me a long time to get over this cold.’

To stop over (a stopover) – when a plane stops in a city and then the passengers have to catch another plane to reach their destination. To pass through another city in a plane, stop there and then leave.

To take over (‘a takeover’) – when an outside force takes control of something.

‘The troops took over the city.’

Meaning two: to repeat

To go over – to rehearse or to look at a piece of information again.

‘OK actors. Let’s go over this one more time to make it perfect.’

3. Personal development

A good place to start with a new group of students is vocabulary for the purpose of studying. Most will have plenty to say as they are English students themselves.

Education

First, brainstorm education and examination vocabulary such as:

- To take an exam
- To retake an exam
- To pass and fail
- Classes, lessons
- Qualifications
- Degree
- Secondary school (UK)
- High school (US)
- To train, to do training
- Teacher, tutor, professor

Next, select some of the following vocabulary to teach depending on your students' level and needs.

Applying for a course

To apply for a course (v), **to send an application** (n) – to submit an application to an educational institution.

To enrol (UK), **to enroll** (US) – to register or sign up for a course.

Enrolment (UK), **enrollment** (USA).

Tuition fees – the money the institution charges to do a course.

Vocational training – training to do a particular job.

Examinations

To cheat in an exam – to do something against the rules in an exam in order to gain an advantage.

To get a result, mark, driver's licence – to receive a qualification or result.

To get stuck on a problem – to be blocked because you can't solve a problem.

To mark an exam – to assess an exam and give it a final grade.

To learn/know something by heart – to memorise something.

To revise for an exam(v), to do revision (n) – to review and memorise the subject in order to get a good mark in the exam.

The good stuff: exams

To pass an exam with flying colours – to pass an exam with an excellent result (UK).

To ace an exam – to pass an exam with an excellent result (US).

To scrape by in an exam – to pass with the minimum mark.

To fail an exam miserably – to fail spectacularly.

Conversation starters

- What are the positives about the education system in your country? What are the negatives?
- Your school years are the best years of your life. Do you agree/disagree?
- What advice would you give to someone about to do an important exam?
- Have you ever passed an exam with flying colours?
- Tell us something that you learned by heart.

Ability

Skill is a useful language topic. It's important to stress that English speakers use the preposition 'at' to express their ability and not 'in' as in other European languages. After mastering the most common terms, students will enjoy learning a few of the fun phrases below.

Essential vocabulary

To be good, bad, terrible, great **at** something.

To find + **gerund** + easy, difficult, hard.

To master something – to become an expert at something through practice and dedication.

To be a talented + occupation.

'He is a talented tennis player.'

To have the right skill set for a job.

A (steep) learning curve – something that is difficult to learn at first.

The good stuff: ability

Advance your stronger students by teaching them these common phrases.

To be a piece of cake – something is so easy that you can do it without thinking.

'Getting around this city is a piece of cake if you use the metro.'

It's not rocket science – it's easier than the person first thought.

'I can bake a cake. It's not rocket science!'

Not to blow your own horn/trumpet –when you want to appear modest before you tell someone your abilities.

'Not to blow my own trumpet but I am quite good at painting.'

To not give up your day job – to be not good at something (funny).

Conversation starters

Ask your students to put these activities in order for them from the easiest to the most difficult. Which ones were difficult to master and which were a piece of cake?

- Ironing
- Learning the rules of the road
- Saying the ‘right’ thing in social situations
- Tying shoelaces
- Learning an instrument
- Navigating relationships
- English spelling

4. Jobs and careers

When teaching work vocabulary, you'll encounter issues with the verb '*to fire*.' Due to TV shows like *The Apprentice*, students will often happily say that they were fired from their last job while the teacher winces and asks whether that's really the case.

To correct this problem, a teacher must teach that '*to fire*' means to be dismissed from one's job due to a problem with the employee. If you lose your job because your company no longer needs your services, the phrase is '*to make redundant*' in the UK and '*to lay off*' in the US.

First, brainstorm hiring and work vocabulary such as:

- To fire someone / to get fired
- To hire someone / to be hired
- To work full-time, part-time, shifts or overtime
- To employ, to be employed
- To be unemployed
- To be self-employed
- To resign, to quit

Next, select some of the following vocabulary to teach depending on your students' requirements.

Resigning and redundancies

To make someone redundant / to be made redundant (UK) or to lay off someone / to be laid off (US) – to lose one's job because the company has gone bankrupt or no longer needs the employee.

Redundancy pay (UK)/ Severance pay (US) – the money the employer gives the employee after a redundancy.

The good stuff: resignations

To hand in your resignation – a phrase meaning 'to resign'.

To give notice – the period of time where you continue to work for a company after resigning.

To step down – to resign from an important position.

Public holidays and sick days

Bank holiday (UK)/ Public holiday (US) – time off for festival days

To be entitled to holiday pay and sick pay – the time off your company agrees to give you in your contract.

To take time off – to take some days off for a vacation.

To take time off sick – to not go to work because of sickness.

Getting promoted

To be headhunted – to be recruited for a top-level job.

To land a job or promotion – to get a promotion or a new job almost by surprise.

To get promoted – to ascend in a company.

To be overlooked / passed over for promotion – to not get the promotion that you feel you deserved because the job went to another candidate.

Conversation starters

- Have you ever taken a sick day when you were not sick? Would you like to share with us why?
- Tell us about a politician or an important person who had to resign from their job and why.
- What are you entitled to as part of your employment contract? How many days holiday?

Job interviews

Roles

To be a candidate – the person offering themselves for a job.

To be an intern – a student or young person who works at a company to gain training and experience.

Internship – noun for ‘intern.’

To oversee – to supervise or manage.

Convincing the interviewer that you can do the job

Background –work and education experience.

To be a good fit – to have the right practical and interpersonal skills for a job.

To commute/ a commute – the journey from your home to work and vice versa.

To cope with something (such as work or pressure) –to manage your emotions and stress levels in a difficult situation.

To suit /soot/ – to be appropriate for something.

To be suitable /soot-ibl/ – adjective of ‘to suit.’

To be willing to do something – to be happy to do something if it is required.

Speaking activity: Job interview practice

Divide your students into pairs. One is the interviewer and the other is the interviewee for a job. Search for common interview questions on the internet and start the role-play. After 10 minutes, switch roles.

5. Business speak

Listen to any results presentations or work meetings and you'll find that English spoken in the business world is very different. As the world of work and business evolves, so do the words that workers use to explain these new ideas and experiences.

In business speak, words merge together to create new nouns and adjectives such as '*a game-changer*' or '*to be hands-on*.' Idioms are popular to convey a large idea in a few words and phrasal verbs are ubiquitous.

This different way of speaking often leaves second language speakers lost in meetings. However, instead of rejecting business speak as 'too difficult,' you'll likely find that workers are eager to master it. They've heard business leaders in shareholder meetings and TED Talks and they want to emulate them.

This chapter is for business English classes. It covers vocabulary divided by language function to teach your students the nouns, adjectives and idioms spoken by native speakers in the business world as well as practical language for office tasks.

Projects

Speaking with clients about a project is one of the main reasons why workers wish to improve their English. Your students will appreciate these phrases.

Starting a project

To give/get the green light – to receive approval from the management to start the project.

To set out – to make plans to achieve something that is rarely or has never been done before.

‘We will set out to become Europe’s largest food delivery service.’

To roll out – to make a new product or service available for the first time.

‘Telefonica will roll out its new network next spring.’

To start from scratch – to start from zero.

To start a project with a kick-off meeting – the first meeting with the project team and client.

To take on – to accept more work, a new project or new responsibility or ‘to hire a new employee.’

Finishing a project

To sign off on the project – the management agrees that the project is complete and done to the agreed standard.

The good stuff: making future plans

Going forward – to anticipate the next steps to take for the company or project.

Looking forward – to anticipate what will happen in the near future.

To foresee – to predict.

The foreseeable future –the near future that you can predict.

To plan ahead – to make plans anticipating any future issues.

Conversation starters

- When you first receive a project from a client, how do you plan it?
- What are the next steps that your department will take going forward?
- Have you ever had to start a project again from scratch? What happened?
- When you finished university, what did you set out to achieve?
- What was the last project you took on? Are you taking on any new staff this year?

Managing people

The below phrases have been collected to help your students communicate with their colleagues.

Delegating

To delegate – to assign a task to a colleague so then they can do it in your place.

To be hands-on – to be a practical person or very involved in a task or business.

To be tech-savvy – to be able to use technology.

To be tasked with something – to be given a task.

To head – to lead or direct.

To oversee – to manage (usually from afar).

To take over – to take control of something from someone or something else.

‘Maria will take over from Steven to lead the project.’

To take the initiative – to do something yourself without being asked.

Verifying tasks

To carry on + gerund / carry on with + noun – to continue an activity.

To carry out – to complete a task or transaction.

‘She’ll carry out the sale next week.’

To catch up with something/someone – to do pending tasks and to find out the latest news from someone.

To kill two birds with one stone – to do two jobs with one action.

Making decisions

To be decisive/ indecisive – someone who decides easily or finds decisions

difficult.

To be up to + pronoun – to leave the decision to someone else.

‘It’s up to her if she wants to increase the budget.’

To make/take a decision – to decide.

A no-brainer – the decision is so easy that you don’t have to use your brain.

To rule out something – to discard an idea as unworkable.

To weigh something up – to analyse the pros and cons of something before making a decision.

Brainstorming

To brainstorm/ to do some brainstorming – to think of a lots of ideas on a topic.

To have a brainwave / bright idea – to have an innovative idea.

A spider chart – to circle the name of the topic and then to write down the ideas associated with it.

To write down / to take down/ to note down information – to quickly put pen to paper to record information.

Exploring pros, cons and results

A drawback – disadvantage.

Upside/ downside – pros and cons.

Outcome – result.

Outlook – view point or financial forecast.

Alerting others of a problem

To warn / to issue a warning – to alert someone to an issue or discipline someone.

A heads-up – to have a warning about something so that you can prepare for it.

A wakeup call – something bad happens which alerts people against making a bigger mistake.

Comprehension and communication

To be on the same page – to understand one another.

To be in the same boat – to have the same problem as someone else.

To be unheard of – to be totally unknown to the point of being strange.

To get to the point – to arrive at the main topic of the conversation.

To keep in touch – to remain in contact.

To keep someone posted – to promise to update someone of your activities.

To read between the lines – to understand the unspoken meaning in a communication.

Conversation starters

- Who is the most decisive person you know? And the most indecisive?
- Give us an example of a ‘no-brainer’ decision.
- What was the wakeup call for you for climate change?
- How do you usually brainstorm ideas in your family or company?
- Give me an example of ‘*to be in the same boat.*’ What about, ‘*to read between the lines*’?

Productivity

The below vocabulary has been curated to help your students talk about progress and productivity as well as motivating others.

Production

Input – a contribution or effort.

Output – what is produced.

To be time-consuming – to take a lot of time.

Lifespan – the duration of a product or person.

Lifecycle – the useable life of a product.

Achieving goals and working hard

Actions speak louder than words – believe what people do and not what they say.

To step up efforts – to increase the effort you put in.

To make a plan of action – to plan a project including all tasks.

To take the bull by the horns – to take control.

Motivating people

To be an invaluable/ irreplaceable member of a team

To be promising/encouraging – something is looking hopeful.

To give someone a break – to stop putting pressure on someone or giving them the benefit of the doubt.

To go for it – to attempt to gain or achieve something.

To have willpower – determination and resolve.

Progress and breakthroughs

To be ahead of the curve – to implement something before competitors.

To be behind the curve – to implement something after your competitors.

To be bulletproof/ fool-proof – to be incapable of going wrong or being misused.

To be forward-thinking – to think ahead.

To be a goldmine – something that could make a lot of money.

To be widely-recognised – to be recognised in many places.

Conversation starters

- How do you organise your week to be the most productive?
- You don't have to be productive all of the time. Do you agree?
Discuss.
- Tell us of a time when actions spoke louder than words.
- Is your country ahead of the curve in terms of its policies to limit climate change compared to other countries or is it behind the curve?

Setting deadlines

Deadlines are a work task that almost everyone has to deal with and so your students will appreciate this vocabulary point.

To set a deadline – to create a deadline.

To meet a deadline – to arrive at the deadline at the agreed time

To reach a milestone – to complete one part of the project.

Time periods

To be due - the agreed or expected date to finish a task or complete a payment.

To be overdue – the expected date has passed and the task or payment is late.

By - the end point

‘We need your answer by Monday.’

Within – inside a time period.

‘Please send us the information within the week.’

The good stuff: schedules

To be behind or ahead of schedule – you will finish earlier or later than you predicted when you set the deadline.

To be on schedule – you are where you expect in the project.

To be on track – to be on schedule.

To get back on track – to return to the right path or schedule when things have gone wrong.

To have a tight deadline – to have a short deadline.

To run out of time, money, patience, battery – when a resource is finished and must be renewed.

Conversation starters

- Are you and your team usually on schedule, behind schedule or ahead of schedule when working on a project?
- Have you ever run out of mobile battery at an important time?
- Who sets the deadlines in your department?
- Are payments ever overdue from clients? What happens?
- What would you like to have accomplished by the end of the year?
- What do you have to do within the next week?

Setting up meetings

To do a conference call – to meet over a video conferencing system.

To do a meeting face-to-face/ in person – to meet in a physical space.

To set up a meeting – to organise a meeting

To arrange, fix, schedule a time or date – to arrange a date to meet.

To meet someone (no ‘with’)/**to meet *up with* someone.**

Confirming meeting times

To suit /suit/– to be convenient or acceptable to you.

To be suitable/ to be convenient (adjectives).

To work – to be acceptable/ convenient.

To be good for + object – the time works for you.

Postponing, cancelling or missing a meeting

To call off – to cancel a meeting or event.

A no-show – someone who is expected at a meeting or event who doesn’t appear.

To put off – to postpone.

To turn up/ to show up – to arrive at a meeting and event when you are expected at.

Conversation starters

- Which is more productive; conference calls or face-to-face meetings?
- When was the last time that someone vital to the meeting didn’t turn up?
- Does it suit you better to have a meeting in the morning or

afternoon?

- Is it acceptable to call off a meeting at the last minute in your company?
- Do mornings or afternoon meetings suit you better?

During the meeting

Client and colleague meetings are the places where students really wish for their English to shine. Help them to communicate more effectively with these verbs, adjectives and idioms.

Expressing ideas and issues

To bring up a subject – to introduce a subject in a meeting.

To come up with an idea – to think of an idea or plan.

To follow up – to continue a meeting with another action.

To move on – to continue to the next topic of the meeting.

To point out – say something to make someone aware of a fact or circumstance.

‘I must point out, we can’t finish this by Christmas.’

To think outside of the box – to think in a non-conventional way.

Expressing that something is going well

To go from strength to strength – to improve.

To go to plan – to achieve what one wanted to do.

To pave the way – to create the conditions for success.

The sky’s the limit – to have no limitations.

Expressing that things are going badly

To be touch and go – to be on the edge of a disaster or death.

To go down in flames – to fail spectacularly.

Expressing that things have been difficult

The calm before the storm – something bad is on the horizon but right now, things are quiet.

To see the light at the end of the tunnel – an indication that a long period of difficulty is nearing an end.

To weather the storm – to survive something difficult.

Conveying that someone has done a bad job

To be out of one's depth – to lack the skills or experience to do something.

To cut corners – to sacrifice quality to save time or money.

To do something half-heartily – to do something without enthusiasm.

To drop the ball – to miss an opportunity because of a lack of alertness.

To shoot oneself in the foot – to do something that causes your own problems or downfall.

Seeing the good in a bad situation

Every cloud has a silver lining – to see the opportunity in a bad situation.

To give up on something

To call it a day – to decide or agree to stop doing something (for forever or for that day).

To throw in the towel – to surrender, to give up.

Mitigating

To mitigate – to lessen the effects of something bad.

The worst (or best) case scenario – the best or worst thing that could happen.

Conversation starters

- Do you usually bring up a difficult issue at the beginning of a meeting or at the end?
- What was the last great idea you came up with?

- What time do you usually call it a day at work?
- Have you ever started a task in your work or personal life and then realised that you were totally out of your depth?
- Tell us about a time when a public figure in your country figuratively shot themselves in the foot?

Problem solving

To be a big deal – an important problem or event.

To deal with – to manage and solve problems or situations.

To find out about – to look for information outside of your immediate knowledge.

To look into a problem – to investigate a problem.

To sort out – to arrange, organise or repair.

To work out / to figure out – to calculate, decipher or find a solution.

The good stuff: dealing with problems

To address the elephant in the room – to confront the big issue or problem that people are avoiding.

As a last resort – as a final option, not your first choice.

To cross that bridge when we come to it – to deal with a problem when it arrives.

A fallback option – a secondary option if the first one fails (a plan B).

To go back to square one/ the drawing board – to start again.

A shortcut – a faster way of doing something or to travel from A to B.

Speaking activity: how do we deal with climate change?

Ask your students to imagine that they are the leaders of the most powerful countries in the world. They must come up with a plan to become carbon neutral in the next 10 years. Brainstorm ideas.

Prompts:

- What is the elephant in the room that the group doesn't want to acknowledge?
- Do you have a fallback option?

- What would be the last resort if everything else fails? Abandon capitalism?
- What about fining polluting companies? How would you figure out an international payment system for this?
- What about rising sea levels. How do we deal with this problem? Do we cross that bridge when we come to it?

Negotiating

To negotiate – to bargain.

A negotiator – the person.

Negotiation tactics/ strategy – a plan to get what you want in a negotiation.

A list of demands – a list of things wanted from the negotiation.

The good stuff: The process of negotiating

The ball is in your court – it's the decision of the other party to make a move.

To be on the table – the things that are being negotiated.

To be off the table – the things that you have agreed will not be included in the negotiation.

'Access to our waters for fishing is off the table but tariff-free trading is still on the table.'

Compromising

To back down over something/ To concede something – to yield a point in a negotiation.

A breakthrough in negotiations – a big step forward in negotiations.

To give/have some leeway – a margin of error.

A trade-off – a compromise.

The bottom-line – the lowest price the party will accept.

The good stuff: problems in negotiations

A deal-breaker – the one thing that must be included or you won't reach an agreement.

A deadlock – when both sides won't move on a point and so the negotiations must stop.

To hold out for a better offer – to wait for something better.

A setback in negotiations – the negotiations take a step back due to a problem.

Speaking activity: the negotiation role play

Divide your students into pairs. Student A has been headhunted for a top management job for a big company. They like their current job but they are interested in the offer. Student B must try to convince student A to join their company. The maximum salary that student B can offer is \$60,000 a year (less than student A's current salary) but they can offer them other perks.

Things that are up for negotiation:

- Annual leave
- Type of company car
- Flexi-working
- Accommodation
- Opportunities to travel.

Making promises

To give someone your word – to promise.

To go back on your word/ to back track on a promise – to undo a promise.

To keep your word – to keep your promise.

Changing your mind

To change your mind (not ‘to change your opinion’).

To have a change-of-heart.

Concluding a negotiation

The outcome – the result or conclusion.

To settle on something – to agree to a lower offer.

To turn down an offer– a polite way to say ‘to reject an offer.’

To walk away from a negotiation – to abandon a negotiation.

A win-win – both sides win.

Contracts and agreements

To add/ remove a clause in an agreement.

To back out of an agreement – to not complete a deal because one party retreats from the agreement.

To be locked into a contract – to not be able to change the contract for a certain period of time.

To do due diligence – to go through the history and paperwork on an item before you buy it.

To draw up an agreement / contract – to make a contract or agreement.

Evaluations

To evaluate – to assess the value or quality of something.

To value – to assess the monetary worth of something.

To be worth – the adjective of ‘to value.’

‘We valued the property and it is worth \$300,000.’

Conversation starters

- Who is the best negotiator you know or know of? Why are they so good?
- Have you ever negotiated a pay rise? What happened?
- What are the pros and cons of being locked into a contract?
- What are all the steps involved in buying a property in your country?

Sales and marketing

Bringing a product to market

To bring a product or service to market – to launch a product or service.

To buy out – to buy another business.

To pitch an idea – to present a sales or advertising idea to an interested party.

To take market share – to expand and become more dominant in your sector.

Research

To do market research – to interview customers and potential customers to investigate what they want from a product and how to improve it.

To network / to do networking – to meet people in your industry to form new connections.

To survey / to do a survey – to conduct a questionnaire with questions related to your business.

To target an audience – to identify people who would be interested in your product and target them with a sales and advertising campaign.

To take advantage of – to profit from.

Announcing the product

A company spokesperson – the nominated person or people in a company who speak to the press.

To showcase a product or service – to demonstrate the use and quality of your product or service to potential customers.

Publicising a product or service

To plug a product or service – to insert the name of a product in a TV

show, movie, song or book.

To hype a product or service / the hype (noun) – to create attention or excitement for your product.

Conversation starters

- Which common product or service is overhyped? A Tesla? The iPhone 11?
- Tell me the steps to bringing a new product or service to market?
- Who is the best at networking in your department? How do they do it?
- What do social media companies like Facebook do to help companies target an audience?
- How do you feel when YouTubers plug a product in their videos? When is it acceptable and when is it not?

The good stuff: hyping a product

To be a closely-guarded secret – to be top secret.

To be eye-catching – to be brightly or differently designed.

To be a must-have – a highly desirable item.

To be ground-breaking – to be revolutionary.

To be game-changing – to change the way we do something.

To be long-lasting – to be durable.

To be state-of-the-art – to be the latest technology.

To have a feel-good-factor – something about the product that makes customers feel good.

The good stuff: hyping a company

To be a market-leader – to lead the market in something.

To be a house-hold name – a famous brand or person.

To be world-class – to be the best quality.

To be world-famous – to be recognised around the world.

Offering something for free

A free trial – when someone can try the service for free.

To trial – to try a product in order to test its quality and use.

To give away – to give something away for free.

‘My company is giving away free samples this week.’

Speaking practice: sell me a product

Divide your students into pairs. Give each person an interesting classroom or household object. Each student must try to sell the object to their partner using some of the vocabulary above.

Explaining data and results

First, brainstorm the types and features of charts such as

- Pie chart
- Bar chart
- A diagram
- Line graph
- Scatter graph
- Info graphic
- X and Y axis
- Dotted lines

Explaining data

Increases

To experience steady growth – to grow slowly and predictably.

To increase, to grow, to rise - to rise, to have rose, to have risen.

To peak, a peak – the highest point in a graph.

To reach a high point – another way of saying ‘the peak.’

To shoot up – a large increase.

To spike – a dramatic peak in a chart.

Decreases

To decrease, to drop, to fall - to fall, to have fell, to have fallen.

To decline, a decline – a gradual decrease.

To experience a decrease/ a drop/a fall in something.

To plummet, a plummet – a dramatic fall.

The lowest point, the trough, the dip – the lowest point in a graph.

Up and down

To fluctuate – the amount swings up and down.

To bounce back – to return to a previous higher level.

No Change

To level off

To remain constant/stable

Trends and reading data

To buck the trend –to do something different from what is currently popular or happening.

To see an upward trend – an increasing tendency or trend.

To see a downward trend – a decreasing tendency or trend.

A range – the numbers between a lower and upper amount.

A trajectory – the path of a curve in a graph.

Presenting information

To represent

To show/ to demonstrate

To illustrate/ to describe

Making comparisons

To compare to, in comparison to

As opposed to, versus

Percentages

Percent – a specified amount in or out of every hundred.

Percentage points – arithmetic difference of two percentages.

A proportion – a part, share or number considered in comparative relation

to a whole.

Number + **out of** + number (not 'from').

Speaking practice: analyse a graph

Go to Statista.com. With a free basic account, you can access basic statistics (which is all you need) covering graphs and charts about the birth rates in different countries, health outcomes and some industry data. Select a graph and ask your students to analyse it to see if they spot any trends.

Idea prompts

- Do you see any upward or downward trends?
- How does this compare to...?
- Why do you think there is a steady growth, fall or spike in this graph?
- When did _____bounce back? Is it levelling off?

6. Work tasks

This chapter covers all of the common work tasks to help staff communicate with their colleagues and clients in their working hours.

Selling a product

First, brainstorm general sales vocabulary such as:

- To accept cash, debit and credit card
- Client (buyer of services)
- Customer (buyer of products)
- To purchase
- Retail/ retailer
- A supplier
- Wholesale/ wholesaler

Making the sale

This product would be a good fit for you because...

Can I put you down for [number of products]? (Selling products).

Can I sign you up for [period of time]? (Selling services).

Prices and payments

A bargain – a low price for an item.

To bargain – to reduce the price through negotiation.

To be good value for money – a more positive way to say ‘cheap’.

To buy in bulk – to buy a large quantity of a particular at one time for a reduced price

To give a discount/ to get a discount – to receive a discount.

To give % off / to get % off – to receive a discount.

Methods of payment

An upfront payment – money that you pay in advance to reserve the product.

To pay in instalments – to pay for the product in small regular payments.

To modify a product for a customer

A bespoke design / To be tailor-made – the product is made or modified to fit the customer's needs.

To tailor a product to your needs – to modify a product for your needs.

Customer support

A warrantee/ a guarantee.

To assure – to tell the customer something that helps them trust the product or service.

Assurance – a verbal guarantee (not 'insurance').

Speaking practice: selling a second-hand car

Divide your students into pairs. Give them each a picture of an interesting vintage vehicle that you have found on the internet. Ask one student to try to sell the car to their partner.

Things to think about:

- Discounts
- Methods of payment
- Warrantees
- Modifications to fit the customer's vision

Telephones

Telephone etiquette in English is different from that of other languages. In English, both the caller and the receiver refer to themselves and the other person in third person. We say ‘*Hello, this is John*’ and not ‘*Hello, I am John*.’ To refer to the other person, we ask ‘*Is this Maria?*’ and not ‘*Are you Maria?*’

To practice this idea, try the telephone role-play below.

To get started, first brainstorm telephone vocabulary such as:

- To answer a phone call.
- To call/ ring someone (to ring, rang, rung)
- Caller (person)
- To charge your phone battery
- To pick up the phone
- To receive a missed call
- Mobile phone (UK), cell phone (US)
- Smartphone
- Voicemail/ to send a voicemail
- To return a call/ to call someone back

Calling people

To hang up the phone (to hang up, hung up, hung up) – when the call ends.

To get back to someone – to return someone’s request or call.

The phone line is engaged or busy – you can’t connect because the line is already occupied.

To get through to someone on the phone – to connect with someone.

Answering a call

Hello, this is Sarah.

Sarah speaking.

Who is calling/ on the line please?

Finishing a call

Speak soon.

We'll be in touch.

It was a pleasure to speak to you.

It was good to hear from you (when you were waiting for the call).

The good stuff: calling people

To dial a number – to input a telephone number into your phone

To get cut off – the phone connection is interrupted by accident.

To hold the line – to wait for someone to answer after you have connected/ to ask someone else to wait while you find information.

To be put on hold (to hold, held, held) – when you are waiting for someone to answer your call after you have connected.

Conversation starters

- What is your personal record for holding the line when phoning a company? Can you tell us more?
- In the age of WhatsApp and email, is it now impolite to call someone? Why/why not?
- How many numbers can you dial from memory? How long did it take you to memorise your own telephone number?
- How do you end a phone call with someone that you don't want to speak to? Do you just hang up?

Cell phones

To buy more credit for your phone (for pay per call contracts).

To have coverage – the mobile network works in your area.

To run out of battery –you must charge your battery because it is getting low.

The telephone network is down – the network doesn't work temporarily.

Speaking practice: the Amazon Telephone role-play

The Amazon Telephone role-play' is a pair-based activity to practice telephone skills. It is especially useful for ESL business classes as the students are keen to practice taking down information on the phone

Divide your students into pairs and place them back to back. Hand Student A Part A of the telephone role-play and explain that they work for Amazon in the dispatch department.

It's Christmas and they have a lot of packages to send from their Madrid headquarters. They must verbally explain the information on the sheet to Student B at DHL who will send the packages to the clients.

Student B writes down all of the information that is given to them. Student B cannot see the sheet as they are facing away from Student A.

All information must be given verbally. If Student B doesn't understand something, they must ask questions.

For fun, tell your students that they have been cut off 5 minutes into the conversation and must restart the call.

Other problems:

- A cat has entered the call centre. Student B must be put on hold while Student A sorts out the problem.
- Student B moves into an area where there is no coverage and gets

cut off.

Download the Amazon Telephone Role-play from the book's website here:

<https://www.bilinguanation.com/tefl-roleplay-the-telephone-roleplay>

Writing letters and emails

Greetings

Dear + first name / **Dear Mr, Ms, Mrs, Miss** + surname.

Hi + name (informal)

To whom it may concern – when you don't know the name of the recipient.

Introducing your subject

I hope this email finds you well (followed by the subject.)

Alternatively, introduce the subject immediately. Many people prefer this option).

I am writing to + subject.

I am contacting you + subject.

Regarding, concerning + subject (formal language).

Further to – to tell the recipient that you are writing about a previous communication.

Responding to a letter or email

Thank you for your email/ thank you for contacting us.

Plus:

- Your action: (e.g. *'We are looking into your case now...'*)
- **To answer your question...**
- **In response, we would like to/we can offer you...**

'Thank you for your email. To answer your question, we can give you a refund on your purchase so long as you still have the receipt.'

Follow up communication after a meeting

It was a pleasure to meet you.

Do not to hesitate + infinitive.

To drop us a line – an informal way of saying ‘please write to us.’

Scheduling

I am writing to schedule a day for the meeting/ when you would be available to meet.

At your convenience – when it suits the reader.

Cancelling

To reschedule

Due to unforeseen circumstances – something has suspended a plan.

In light of – a formal phrase to say ‘because of.’

The good stuff: email abbreviations

BTW – by the way.

ASAP – as soon as possible.

ATT – attention.

FYI – for your information.

TBD – to be decided.

RSVP – “répondez s’il vous plaît

Proposals

To quote / to give a quote – how much a job will cost a client.'

To propose / a proposal – the proposed solution to a client's problem.

A scope of work – all tasks in the proposal broken down into bullet points.

Attachments

Please find attached + document.

Replying to a complaint

To be deeply sorry.

We can assure you/ please be assured.

To look into an issue or matter – to investigate.

Giving bad news

Regretfully, unfortunately...

To have considered...

To decline – a formal, polite way to say 'no' to invitations, proposals and offers.

Finishing a communication

To be in touch (shortly).

To hope + infinitive.

To look forward to + gerund/noun.

Endings

Best wishes, Best regards, Best, Kind regards – for emails.

Yours sincerely –for letters (when you know name of the receiver).

Yours faithfully – for letters (when you don't know the name of the receiver)

Writing tasks

Ask your student to write a 150-word email. Here are some suggestions:

- A complaint letter to a train company
- A covering letter for a job interview
- A business proposal.
- An apology letter to a customer

Writing reports and articles

Types of writing

An article – in newspapers and magazines.

A blog post – an article on a website.

An essay – a written argument.

A first draft – a rough first copy or attempt.

‘The first draft of your essay was interesting but it needs to be polished.’

A review – an opinion piece on a product or piece of entertainment.

A report – an informational piece of writing.

Titles and headings

Capital letter (ABC), **lower-case letter** (abc)

Paragraph

Title / subtitle – used in essays/books

The headline – used in newspapers

Sub-headline – used in newspapers

Functions

To paraphrase – to put what someone said into your own words.

To spell/ spelling – to write a word using the correct letters

To quote/ a quote – to repeat or write the words spoken by another person.

To underline/ to highlight – to draw under a word or phrase to give

emphasis.

Presentations

Starting a presentation

An anecdote – a short story related to the issue.

A quote – a quote from a significant person related to the issue.

Emphasising a point

And that's not all – a big extra point.

Not to mention – a big extra point.

Answering questions

To take some questions

To fire away

Ending a presentation

In conclusion/ to conclude.

In summary/ to summarise.

To wrap up – when you want to end a presentation quickly.

The key takeaways – the important information to take from the presentation.

To leave you with a thought...

A call to action – an encouragement to do something talked about in the presentation.

Speaking practice: give your own TED Talk

Practice presentation skills in class by asking students to come up with their

own TED Talk on an issue that interests them.

7. Free time

Hobbies

Brainstorm hobbies such as:

- Chess
- Creative writing
- Gardening
- Playing board games
- Knitting or sewing
- Photography
- Painting or drawing
- Walking or hiking

Starting, stopping and feeling passionate about a hobby

To be into something – to have a passion for something.

To get into something – to develop a passion for something.

To give up – to cease a hobby, habit or activity.

To take up – to start a hobby, habit or activity.

To sign up for something – to put your name down for classes.

Conversation starter

- What sports or hobbies are you into?
- What did you use to be into when you were younger that you have since given up?
- If you had more time, what classes would you sign up for?
- Have you ever taken something up only to give it up a short time later?

Sports and physical activity

First, brainstorm sport and movement activities such as:

- To warm up
- To cool down
- To stretch
- To work out, a workout
- To lift weights
- To kick the ball
- To hit the ball
- To pass the ball
- To shoot the ball
- To save a goal

Ball sports

A foul / to foul – to try to get the ball from an opponent illegally.

To score a goal or point – to win a goal or point.

A tackle / to tackle – to make contact with an opponent to try to get the ball.

Goalkeeper, attacker, defender, striker – the player who scores the goals.

Results

To draw/ to tie – when both sides score the same amount.

To beat another team – to win against another team.

To win/lose the match.

Conversation starters

- What sports do you like doing? How do you warm up?
- Tell us about an exciting match you have watched or played. Who scored the goals/ points?
- Is fouling a big problem in the sport that you play/like?
- [Teacher writes down some scores] What is the score in these matches?

Locations

- An ice rink.
- Tennis court, basketball court, volleyball court
- Football or baseball pitch
- Running track. Within the track. there are 'lanes'.
- Swimming lanes.
- Ski slope/piste

Equipment

- Locker
- Gym
- Whistle, to whistle
- Gym kit
- Shin pads

The good stuff: sports with do, play and go to

The rules

It's **'to do sports'** when the activity is inside and without a ball.

For example, *'to do aerobics, spinning, yoga, karate or boxing.'*

It's **'to play sports'** when the activity uses a ball.

For example, *'to play tennis, football, golf, hockey, basketball or volleyball.'*

It's **'to go + gerund'** when the activity is outside but without a ball.

For example, *'to go skiing, surfing, horse riding, running, walking, swimming, sailing, climbing or hiking.'*

Speaking activity

The teacher says the sport and the student must guess whether it goes with 'to

do', 'to go' or 'to play.'

Films

Brainstorm cinema and movie production vocabulary such as:

- Audience
- Popcorn
- Kiosk
- To usher, usher (person)
- Ticket
- Cup-holder
- Screen
- Speakers
- To release a film/movie
- To show a movie (not 'to project a movie')

Genres

Brainstorm different genres such as:

- Adventure
- Drama
- Comedy
- Horror
- Romcom (romantic comedy)
- Science fiction
- Thriller
- Western

The good stuff: rating films

An age-rating – parental guidance for the suitability of a film for children.

To award an award, to give an award – a prize in recognition of an achievement.

To be fringe – unconventional.

To be mainstream – conventional.

To flop, a flop – the movie fails.

To rate, rating – the stars given by reviewers to assess the movie quality.

To review, a review – the text written to rate the movie quality.

To overrate, to be overrated – to rate too highly.

To underrate, to be underrated – to rate too low.

Making films

- To animate, animation
- Cast
- Director
- Main character
- Script writer
- Producer
- Plot
- To perform, performance
- The set
- Special effects
- Soundtrack
- Screenplay
- Script, scriptwriter
- Supporting role

The good stuff: making films

The scene – a part of a movie.

To star in a movie – to be one of the main characters in a movie.

To be set in – when and where the story is placed.

To make a comeback – something that was popular before and then fell from popularity makes a ‘big return.’

A must-see – a film, place or event that someone must see.

A flashback – a scene in a film or novel set in a time earlier than the main story.

A cliff-hanger – an exciting end to a film when something has yet to be resolved.

Conversation starters

- What is a 'must-see' film in your opinion?
- Has a film ever been set in your home city, province or town?
Tell us the story.
- Which films are overrated in your opinion? Can you tell us about a film that you think is underrated?
- Can you name a film star who made a comeback? What was their comeback film?
- Do you prefer mainstream or fringe cinema?

Newspapers

First, brainstorm media vocabulary such as:

- An article
- A blog post
- Current affairs
- To be a journalist
- To work in journalism
- To publish
- To post
- A press release
- To review / a review
- To subscribe / to have a subscription
- Subscriber

More newspaper vocabulary

Agony aunt – someone who gives readers advice.

Broadsheet newspaper – a more serious, larger newspaper with longer, more difficult to read articles.

To censor, censorship – the suppression or prohibition of media which is considered obscene or politically unacceptable.

Paywall – a wall that newspapers put on their news sites to charge for articles.

Scandal – an outrageous/scandalous action.

Tabloid newspaper – a non-serious, easy-to-read newspaper that is often focused on sports and celebrities along with politics.

The good stuff: newspapers

To catch up with the news – to update yourself with the latest news after you haven't read it in a while.

To keep yourself updated with the news – to stay updated with the latest

news.

Readers – people who read something (countable noun).

Readership – the noun for ‘readers’ (uncountable noun).

Objectivity

To be biased – to be partial/ unobjective.

To be unbiased – to be impartial/ objective.

Conversation starters

- Are newspapers dead? Why/why not?
- How do you catch up with the news?
- What can newspapers do to boost their readership numbers?
- Can there ever be such a thing as unbiased reporting? Why/why not?
- What are the best and worst newspapers in your country?

Travel

First, brainstorm holiday and travel vocabulary such as:

- To book a holiday / to make a booking
- To check into a hotel/ to check out of a hotel
- Holiday (UK), Vacation (US)
- Journey
- Passenger
- Plane ticket
- To pack your suitcase (not 'to make your suitcase')
- To travel (verb), trip (noun)
- Traveller (person)

Types of holidays

A city break – a short holiday to a city.

To go backpacking – to travel around the world with a backpack.

A spa break – when you visit a spa for relaxation purposes.

At the airport

To arrive (verb) **arrivals** (noun) – to arrive at a place.

Baggage/luggage collection.

To board an airplane – to get on an airplane.

To depart (verb) **departures** (noun) – to leave a place for a destination.

Flight attendant – servers on a flight.

To get off an airplane / to disembark and airplane – to leave an airplane.

To land / the landing – when a plane arrives at the airport.

To take off / the take-off – when a plane flies up into the air

Advanced

Aisle – the path down the centre of the plane.

To fasten your seatbelts – to put on the safety belt.

Overhead luggage compartment.

Rows – the lines of seats in a plane.

Hotels

Bed and breakfast – a small family-run hotel where you receive a room and breakfast.

Hostel – basic accommodation when you are backpacking.

Motel – a basic hotel by a large road where people stop for the night.

Room service – food and drink are brought to your room.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about a difficult flight that you have had in the past. Was there any turbulence?
- Have you ever had any problems in an airport such as being stopped by security or missing your flight?
- Do you prefer the landing or take-off? Why?
- Have you ever been backpacking? Did you enjoy it or was it just very uncomfortable?

Time

To be an hour ahead/ behind – the time zones of other countries.

The day before yesterday – past yesterday.

The day after tomorrow – past tomorrow.

Jetlag – when you feel tired at strange times of the day due to moving to a different time zone.

Things to do on holiday

To sightsee / to go sightseeing – to see monuments and museums.

To do a guided tour of the city – to do an organised trip around the city.

To go + gerund – for outdoor sports activities.

To go hiking, skiing, kayaking, climbing, surfing or sailing.

Speaking practice: I'm coming to your hometown role-play

Divide your students into pairs. Each student is going to their partner's hometown or their favourite holiday destination. Discuss the best things to see and do in that area and what to avoid.

Shopping

First, brainstorm shopping vocabulary such as:

- Aisle
- Basket
- Changing rooms
- Clothing, shoe size
- Customer
- to exchange
- Hanger
- Receipt
- To pay for something
- Sales
- Shop assistant
- Trolley (UK), shopping cart (US)
- Till, checkout

Phrases for buying clothes

To get a discount/ to get money off – to reduce the price of something.

To go window shopping – to look at items in a shop without buying them.

An item of clothing – one piece of clothing.

To look for something – to search for something.

To refund/ to get a refund – to have money returned.

To suit /soot/ – expression to say an item of clothing looks good on someone.

To try on clothes – to try clothes on before you buy.

To take something back – to return something to a shop.

Fashion

To be stylish/ in fashion / in style/ trendy – to wear the latest fashion.

To be out of fashion – the fashion has passed.

To be timeless – when a piece is always in style.

To dress to impress/ to kill – to be dressed in a stylish way.

To make a comeback – when something that was out of fashion becomes fashionable again.

Conversation starters

- How have shopping habits changed in the last 10 years?
- Many retailers are going out of business due to online shopping habits. Does this worry you? Should we try to stop it or is it a natural evolution of business?
- What do you know about fast fashion's impact on the environment?
- Do you avoid fast fashion or are cheap clothes too difficult to resist?
- Do you make character judgements of people you've just met based on what they wear? Have you ever been wrong?

Dining out

Brainstorm restaurant vocabulary such as:

- The bill
- Chef
- Dessert
- Dish
- The dish of the day
- Knife, fork, spoon, teaspoon
- Menu
- Main course
- Starter
- To serve
- Serviette (UK), napkin (US)
- Waiter/ waitress

More vocabulary

Beverage – another word for ‘drink.’

Condiment – sauces; ketchup, mustard etc.

A doggy bag / leftovers – the food that you don’t eat in a restaurant to take home.

Set menu – a starter, main course and dessert for a set price.

Maître d – person who welcomes diners in expensive restaurants.

Seasoning – salt and pepper.

Salad dressing, to dress a salad – oil and sauces for salads.

Soft drink – coke, lemonade or juice.

Taster menu – a series of small dishes for tasting.

To tip, to leave a tip – a small amount of money for the waiting staff.

Dining phrases

To order – to ask for food and drink.

To take someone's order – when the waiting staff note what you want to order.

To make a reservation, to book a table.

Conversation starters

- Are services like Just Eat and Uber Eats changing our weekend habits? In what way?
- What is the worst service you have ever received? Tell us about it. What is the best service?
- Do you eat out more or less than your parents? Why is this, do you think?
- Would you ever become a chef? Do you know anyone who is a chef? What is their working week like?

8. Healthy living

Healthcare and medicine

Health is such an enormous subject that teachers need to be selective in the vocabulary that they teach. Most of the time, students just need a few phrases in case they get sick abroad. If you have to teach healthcare professionals, you will have to go deeper.

First, brainstorm not-so-common body vocabulary such as:

- Ankle
- Cheek
- Forehead
- Fingers, toes
- Elbow

- Neck
- Hip
- Knee
- Waist
- Wrist

At the doctor's: How to explain sensations

There are several ways to explain sensations such as:

Body part + '**ache**' for sensations that are not extremely strong.

I have:

- backache
- a headache
- a stomach ache

Sore+ body part if the pain is on the surface.

I have:

- a sore throat
- a sore finger
- a sore knee

Body part + **hurt/ to hurt** + body part when something is damaged.

For example:

‘My finger hurts. I think it’s broken.’

Other ways to talk about sensations and fainting

To faint/ to black out – to lose consciousness.

To feel numb/ to have numbness – no sensation.

To have a **tingling** sensation/ to have **pins and needles** – an uncomfortable prickling sensation.

To be **painful/ to be in agony** – to cause someone a lot of pain.

Common illnesses

- To be allergic, to suffer from allergies
- Chickenpox (varicella)
- A cold
- Flu
- High blood pressure
- Nausea, to feel nauseous
- A rash
- A sore throat
- Stomach ache, headache
- A temperature, a fever
- To vomit, throw up, be sick

Common injuries

- To dislocate
- To break a bone
- To fracture a bone
- To injure yourself/ to get injured
- To pull a muscle
- To sprain/ to twist an ankle
- To swell (to swell, swelled, swollen)

The good stuff: at the doctors

To do a check-up – this is a revision of your body.

To explain your family history – the medical background of a person's family.

To feel under the weather – to feel weak and ill, usually with a cold.

To feel dizzy, light-headed – to feel disorientated like you are going to lose consciousness.

The good stuff: the Covid-19 pandemic of 2020

An epidemic – an outbreak of a disease in one region.

A pandemic – an outbreak of a disease in multiple regions.

To infect/ infection – to pass a disease to someone.

To lockdown/ to go into lockdown – the people of a country or city self-isolate until the threat of contagion has passed.

The rate of infection – the speed at which a disease passes itself from one person to another.

To quarantine / to go into quarantine – to remove yourself from others until the threat of contagion has passed.

To vaccinate / vaccine – to treat with a vaccine to produce immunity

against a disease.

Treatments

To bandage an arm/leg – to wrap material bandages around a limb.

Crutches – sticks to help a person with an injured leg or foot walk.

To put an arm or leg in plaster – to wrap a hard substance around a patient's limb to stop it moving.

To put an arm in a sling – a piece of material tied around the shoulder to support an injured arm or hand.

To run some tests – to take samples from a person to send to a laboratory.

To do an x-ray – a radiograph.

At the pharmacy

Dosage – the amount of medicine that a patient can take safely at one time

Drowsy/ non-drowsy – medicine that makes the patient feel sleepy or not.

Oral medicine – medicine taken through the mouth.

Over-the-counter medicine – medicine that a patient can buy without a prescription.

Painkillers – common term for medicine that stops pain.

To prescribe prescription – medicine prescribed by a doctor.

To cause side effects – a secondary, typically undesirable, effect of a drug or medical treatment.

Topical medicine – medicine taken by rubbing it on the skin.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about a time when you ended up in hospital.
- Tell us about a time when you got sick on holiday.
- Tell us about your experiences during the 2020 Covid-19 Pandemic.
- Are you satisfied with the healthcare system in your country? Why/why not?

Sleep

To be asleep – adjective for sleeping.

To be an insomniac – someone with trouble sleeping.

To be restless sleeper – a person who sleeps badly.

To fall asleep – process of going to sleep.

Jet lag – wanting to sleep at strange times due to moving between time zones.

To keep someone up all night – something/someone prevents a person from sleeping.

To oversleep – to sleep too much and miss something.

To sleep in late – to sleep longer in the morning because you can.

To stay awake – to experience a night of insomnia (not your decision to stay awake.)

To stay up all night – to not sleep at all one night (because it's your decision).

To take a nap – a little sleep in the day.

To take a power nap – a short sleep to reenergise.

Conversation starters

- Are you a morning person or a night person?
- Do people take naps in the day in your culture?
- Tell us about a time when you were kept awake all night.
- Tell us about a time when you overslept and missed something important.

Cooking

Brainstorm ways to cook and prepare a potato, such as:

- To boil
- To roast
- To fry
- To bake
- To stew
- To mash
- To slice and dice

Other cookery words

- To beat, whisk
- To scramble
- To grate
- To steam
- To drain

Conversation starters

- Tell us the method used to cook your favourite main course.
- Tell us the method used to prepare your favourite dessert.
- Who is the best cook in your family? What cooking tips have you learned from them?
- What dishes do you typically prepare for an important festival in your culture?

Alcohol and other bad habits

Brainstorm vocabulary related to alcohol and drugs such as:

- To be an alcoholic (person)
- Alcoholism (n)
- To take drugs
- To be a drug addict (person)
- To be/get drunk
- Spirits
- A mixer
- To be sober
- To toast

Alcohol advanced

To binge drink (v), a binge (n), a binge drinker – to drink a large amount of alcohol for the purpose of getting drunk.

To booze/ to be boozy – UK slang for drinking alcohol or food that has a high alcohol content.

To buy a round of drinks – to buy drinks for the people you're with on the understanding that they'll buy drinks for you.

To have a hangover/ to be hungover – a headache the morning after drinking.

To be/get tipsy – to get a little drunk.

To set your boundaries – to understand your limits and not surpass them.

To take a sip/ to sip – to drink a small amount of liquid from the rim of a cup/glass.

The good stuff: alcohol

To be teetotal – to never drink alcohol.

To drink like a fish – to frequently drink large amounts of alcohol.

To fall off the wagon – to return to your addiction after a period of controlling it.

Hair of the dog – when people drink the morning after to ‘cure’ a hangover.

Peer pressure – the social pressure from people of the same demographic to you to do things that are potentially harmful.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about the alcohol habits in your country? Do people tend to binge drink or do they just get a little tipsy?
- Are millennials more health conscious than their parents or has nothing changed?
- Tell us about an example of peer pressure?
- What are the pros and cons of being teetotal?
- Have you ever had a hangover? How did you cure it?

9. Opinions

Expressing a like or dislike for something

First, brainstorm like and dislike vocabulary such as:

- To like/ love + gerund.
- To be a fan of something.
- To be keen on something.
- To be mad/crazy about something.
- To not like/hate + gerund.
- To loath
- To detest
- To not be able to stand

Expressing a passion

To be into something – to have a passion.

To get into something – to develop a passion.

Expressing a future desire

To look forward to + gerund

‘I am looking forward to going on holiday.’

To not be able to wait to do something

‘I can’t wait to see you this weekend! We’re going to have lots of fun.’

To crave something – to have a strong desire for something (often food or attention).

The good stuff: polite ways to say you don’t like something

It’s not my cup of tea – a British way to say that something ‘is not for you.’

‘You go and play tennis if you want to but it’s not my cup of tea.’

(Alternatives: **‘It’s not my thing’, ‘It’s not for me.’**)

To not be a big fan of something.

Liking and disliking people

To get on well with someone – to have a good relationship with someone.

To fall out with someone – to have an argument and stop liking someone.

The good stuff: liking and disliking people

To be a role model – someone others look to as a good example.

To be like chalk and cheese – to be two people who get along with opposite personality traits.

To burn bridges with someone – to completely cut your relationship with someone.

To click with someone – to like and get on well with someone immediately.

To fight like cat and dog – to constantly argue with someone.

To get on like a house on fire – when two people meet and really like each other in a friendly way (not romantic).

Conversation starters

- What sports or hobbies are you into and what is not your cup of tea?
- What are you looking forward to doing this summer?
- Did you and your siblings or classmates get on well when you were kids or did you fight like cats and dogs?
- Have you ever fallen out with a neighbour? What happened?
- Have you ever burned your bridges with a previous company or relationship or is it important for you to remain on good terms?

Expressing an opinion

First, brainstorm ways to express your opinion such as:

- In my opinion...
- I think, I believe...
- I am in favour of...
- I feel that...
- I reckon... (informal)
- To be for something
- To be against something

The good stuff: expressing your honest opinion

Frankly, truthfully.

To be honest.

To tell the truth.

Changing one's mind

To change your mind.

To have a change of heart.

To include wider issues

To keep in mind/ To bear in mind – to remain aware of something.

Expressing your point of view

Personally speaking.

From my point of view.

As far as I'm concerned.

Agreeing and disagreeing

To agree/ disagree (v)

To be right/ that's right – to say that something makes sense/ you agree.

To come to an agreement – to arrive at an agreement.

To compromise –two parties find a middle ground.

To agree to disagree –two parties cannot come to an agreement but respect each other's views.

The good stuff: agreeing and disagreeing

To be give and take – a compromise where both parties give a little until everyone is satisfied.

To find common ground – to find something that you agree on.

To jump to conclusions – to decide something without considering all of the facts.

To play devil's advocate – to present both sides of the argument.

To see eye-to-eye – to agree, to have the same perspective about something.

Persuasion

To convince / to persuade

To get your own way –to get or do what you want in spite of opposition.

To win over – to pursue someone to your side of the argument.

Exploring the advantages and disadvantages

The advantages and disadvantages

The pros and cons.

The upside and the downside.

The drawback(s) – the disadvantage.

On the other side of the coin – the other side of the argument.

Explaining your reasons

Due to + noun/ **Due to the fact** + verb

Since / as + verb

Thanks to + noun (only for positive results).

Therefore + verb

When you're not sure of the facts

As far as I know...

In theory...

To my knowledge...

Off the top of my head...

Making comparisons

To compare(v), in comparison (n)

Whereas – a combination of ‘while’ and ‘in comparison.’

The good stuff: ways of thinking

To be common-sense – what you expect or to be rational/reasonable.

To be counter-initiative – to be the opposite of what you expect.

To be human nature – to be the way that people commonly behave.

To be a trend-setter – to be the first person to do something which others follow.

To go against the grain – to do something against the common way of

thinking, living or working.

To go in-depth – to explore the details of an argument or topic.

Giving examples

Especially, particularly, specifically.

Let me give you an example.

For instance.

Such as + list

Referencing a source

Regarding, concerning.

In relation to.

Namely.

According to.

The good stuff: personal opinions, things and experiences

Good: To think that something is **great, fantastic** or **wonderful**.

Medium: To think that something is **alright, not bad** or **so-so**.

Bad: To think that something is **awful, terrible** or **rubbish**.

To take it or leave it – when your opinion on something is neutral.

‘I don’t mind watching basketball. But to be honest with you, I can take it or leave it.’

Debate questions

Ask your students to explore these issues in a pair-based speaking practice.

- Should there be an age limit on driving?

- What are the pros and cons of allowing parents to home school their children?
- What are the pros and cons of allowing taxi apps like Uber and Lyft to operate in a city?
- Marriage is outdated. Do you agree/disagree? Discuss.

Criticising

To criticise (v), **criticism** (n), **critic** (person).

To give constructive criticism – to critique something in a positive way.

To critique – to assess something critically, often pieces of artwork.

To give/ receive feedback – to give and receive an evaluation of someone's work.

The good stuff: self-criticism

To be a perfectionist – someone who always wants things to be perfect.

To be self-critical (adjective) – someone who often criticises themselves.

To be hard on yourself – someone who is very critical of themselves.

Receiving criticism

To have thick skin – to not be affected by negative criticism.

To have thin skin – to be very affected by negative criticism.

To take something to heart – to let negative criticism affect you.

Extreme criticism

To troll someone (v), **a troll** (person) – to criticise someone in an unfair and offensive way, commonly on the internet.

Conversation starters

- When does public criticism become trolling?
- What is the difference between critiquing and criticising?
- Would you say that you have a thick or thin skin? Have you changed as you have got older?
- Do you know anyone who is hard on themselves? What advice do you give them?

10. Emotions and behaviours

Intermediate students and above usually know the basic adjectives necessary to express emotions. However, they lack the vocabulary to go deeper into how they feel. The following chapter addresses this knowledge gap. My advice is to teach two emotions or behaviours in one session, one negative and one positive, in order to balance the topic.

Tiredness and boredom

To be bored/ boring (adj), **boredom** (n).

To be stuck in a rut – to be trapped in a boring life.

To be exhausted/ exhausting – very tired.

To not be able to carry on/ go on – physically tired to the point of ceasing all activity.

To be tired/ tiring.

To be sleepy – to want to sleep.

Excitement and happiness

To be cheerful– to have joy in your heart that day, to be happy.

To be delighted about/with something – to be very happy about something.

To get excited about something – to have enthusiasm for something.

To be exhilarated / exhilarating – something is thrilling.

To be enthusiastic – to be excited or keen to do something.

To be glad– to have gratitude or to be happy for someone.

‘I am glad he got the job.’

To be hair-raising – scary in an exciting way.

To be overjoyed – to be extremely happy.

The good stuff: happiness

To jump for joy – to be so happy that you jump.

To be over the moon – to receive very happy news.

To make my day – something happens to improve your day.

To feel on top of the world/ to be on cloud nine – to be very happy.

Awkwardness and embarrassment

To be embarrassed/embarrassing.

To be/act strange– to behave in an unusual or peculiar way.

To be/ act weird – to behave in an unusual or peculiar way.

To be/ feel awkward – to feel uncomfortable in a situation.

To cringe/ to be cringy– to feel embarrassment for someone else.

‘That award acceptance speech was so cringy, I was dying inside.’

Conversation starters

- Give me an example of an awkward situation?
- When was the last time someone made your day?
- It is inevitable that adults end up stuck in a rut. Do you agree or disagree? Discuss.
- Long-lasting happiness is an unobtainable dream. Discuss.
- When was the last time you cringed? Do the leaders of your country ever make you cringe?

Fear

All fear carries the preposition ‘*of*’ when speaking about personal feelings.

To be afraid, frightened, scared, terrified of something.

When talking about the characteristic of something else, use:

It is frightening, scary, terrifying.

Other vocabulary

To give a fright – a short, sharp jump of fear.

To be disturbed/ disturbing.

To scare away – to scare someone or an animal so that they/it runs away.

‘The dogs are scaring away the pigeons.’

The good stuff: fear

To be creepy – to give you a bad feeling.

To be scared stiff / to be scared to death – phrase to say that someone is very scared.

To dread – to have a physical reaction because you don’t want to do something.

Anger and annoyance

To anger (v), to be/ get **angry** (adj)

To annoy (v), to be/get **annoyed** (adj)

To be furious – very angry.

To be/ get upset – to feel emotionally unbalanced, distressed

To lose your mind/ to go crazy – to ‘go mad’ because something is annoying you so much.

The good stuff: anger

To drive someone crazy – someone/ something provokes annoyance in you.

‘That noise is driving me crazy.’

To get on someone’s nerves – to annoy someone.

To grin and bear it – to tolerate something difficult.

To make someone mad

To cause a scene – to have a public argument.

To make a fuss –to become angry and complain about something.

Regret

To regret/ to feel remorse – to feel bad about something from the past.

To be regretful (adj)

To mourn – to feel a sense of loss if someone has passed away or they have lost something important.

‘He mourned the end of his marriage.’

That ship has sailed/ to miss the boat – phrase to say ‘that opportunity has passed’.

‘She would have loved to have had children but that ship has sailed.’

Conversation starters

- Are you the type of person who makes a fuss about poor service? Why/why not?
- Have you ever been scared stiff during a flight? Tell us more.
- What’s been driving you crazy lately? Why?
- Do you dread exams or are you pretty calm about them?
- Is it socially unacceptable to cause a scene in public in your country? When was the last time you saw one? Tell us more.

Honesty and lying

To be candid, frank, truthful – synonyms of ‘to be honest.’

To fool / to kid someone – to deliberately mislead or trick someone.

To speak openly/ to speak your mind– to say your honest opinion.

To be sincere/ genuine.

To lie (v), **a lie** (n), **liar** (person).

To cheat (v), **a cheat** (person)– to deceive someone.

To deceive (v), **deception** (n) – to lie, to trick someone.

The good stuff: honesty and lying

To be gullible – to be easily deceived.

To be naive – to be too trusting.

To give someone the benefit of the doubt – to believe someone despite evidence to the contrary.

To tell a white lie – a small lie to prevent someone from feeling hurt.

To be brutally honest – to be honest even if it offends someone.

To take something with a pinch of salt – to believe something is exaggerated or to believe only part of something.

Worry and stress

To be/get nervous

To bottle something up – to become stressed because you can't express your emotions.

To freak out – to feel sudden overwhelming worry.

To make someone nervous – to make someone feel stressed or uneasy.

To be out-of-control – the opposite of 'to be under control.'

To be under pressure – to feel obliged to meet a difficult expectation.

To worry (v), to be worried/ worrying (adj).

To stress (v), to be stressed / stressful.

To tear your hair out – phrase to mean 'to be very stressed.'

The good stuff: stress

To burn out, to suffer from burnout – physical or mental collapse caused by work or stress.

To overwhelm (v), to be overwhelmed/overwhelming – to feel a very strong emotion, often stress.

To be the last straw – the final problem before someone has a breakdown.

To bite off more than you can chew – to have taken on too much work or responsibility.

To be snowed under – to have a mountain of work to do.

Relaxation

To calm down, to settle down.

To breathe a sigh of relief– to be relieved.

To relieve (v), to be relieved (adj) – to alleviate.

To relax (n) to be relaxed/relaxing.

To have/get some downtime – to stop, rest and relax.

To let off steam – to release stress or pressure by doing a physical activity.

Conversation starters

- How do you let off steam at the end of a stressful week?
- Is burnout a problem among your peers? Tell us more.
- What news have you taken with a pinch of salt recently?
- Tell us a story where you or someone close to you freaked out?
- Being snowed under with work is a good thing for an employee. Do you agree, disagree or does it depend? Discuss.
- Who is the most gullible person you know? Can you describe their personality to us?

Disappointment and consoling

To disappoint (v), to be disappointing/disappointed.

To console/ comfort someone – to reassure someone in distress.

To be inconsolable– to be unable to be reassured.

To let someone down– to disappoint.

To feel down/blue – to feel mildly depressed.

Bravery and cowardliness

To be brave (adj)– to be valiant.

To be courageous (adj) – stronger than brave.

To show bravery / courage (n).

To be a coward/ chicken – to avoid danger or confrontation.

To dare – to challenge someone to do something dangerous or difficult.

The good stuff: bravery

To be daring/ adventurous – to like doing difficult or dangerous things.

To be a daredevil – someone who likes to do dangerous things for fun.

To be out of your comfort zone – to do something that you're not accustomed to or comfortable with.

To have a go – to try something new.

Shock and surprise

To shock (v), **to be shocked/shocking** (adj).

To surprise (v), **to be surprising/surprised** (adj).

To be kidding+ object.

Oh my God/gosh! – exclamations for surprising news.

I can't believe it!/ No way! – exclamations for surprising news.

Conversation starters

- Tell us an example of a brave person.
- What is the most surprising thing that has happened to you this year?
- Tell us an example of when you went out of your comfort zone.
- No one is a daredevil after 40. Do you agree or disagree? Discuss.

Risk and security

To be on the safe side – to do something on the side of caution.

To be risk averse – to dislike risk.

To be risk tolerant – to find risk tolerable.

To jeopardise – to put something at risk.

To play it safe – to take the easy or secure option.

To not put all your eggs in one basket – not diversifying is too risky.

To test the water – to see how something is outside of your normal life.

To throw caution to the wind – to take a risk.

A wakeup call – an alert that something is going wrong.

Encouraging someone

To cheer – to animate someone else to do something.

To clap – to applaud.

Come on/ let's go! – exclamations to encourage people.

To encourage (v), **encouragement** (n).

To hang in there – to not surrender or give up.

To make an effort – to exert yourself.

The good stuff: encouraging

'Let's get going' – to animate people to start a journey.

To look on the bright side – to look on the positive side.

To put your back into it – to animate someone to do something that requires physical strength.

Love and closeness

To be a couple.

To break up with someone, a breakup (n) – to terminate a relationship.

To be close to someone – to feel emotionally close to someone.

‘My sister and I are close.’

To fancy someone – to feel attracted to someone (UK English).

To get on well with someone (UK)/ **to get along well with someone** (US) – to have a good relationship with someone but not be extremely close.

To go out with someone (UK)/ **to date someone** (US) – to be romantically attached to someone.

To have a bond/ to bond with someone – to have a strong attachment to someone (usually your child or another close relative).

To love (v), **to be loving** (adj)

To miss someone – to feel sad when someone is not there.

The good stuff: relationships

To dump someone – to break up with someone (colloquial UK English).

To get together with someone – to form a couple.

To get over someone – to start to forget and feel happy again after a relationship has ended.

To have your heart broken – phrase for breakups.

To stand someone up – to not meet someone for a date when you said that you would.

Conversation starters

- Is Covid-19 a wakeup call for the world? What lessons have we learned?
- In the age of the smart phone, it is getting harder to get close to people. Do you agree or disagree? Discuss.
- How important is it that you get on with your co-workers or classmates?
- Give us an example of testing the waters. What about throwing caution to the wind?
- Taking into account the world’s problems, give us an example of looking on the bright side.

11. Social interactions

Small talk

An important objective of higher-level students is to engage in small talk. However, most don't feel like they have the vocabulary to chat, to entertain and to truly feel like and act themselves.

After much thought, these phrases are a summary of the language points that I believe a student needs to have a good conversation with an acquaintance.

How are you? + answers ('not bad', 'could be better', 'fine', 'good thanks.')

To like/ to be into – for speaking about hobbies.

'I am into skiing.'

What do you think about? + opinion vocabulary

What's the weather like? + weather vocabulary

To look forward to + gerund – for future desirable events.

'Are you looking forward to your holidays?'

What + be + like? – for asking about characteristics.

'What is your job like?' 'What is your city like?'

Other useful conversational phrases

Long time, no see.

To be a big deal – something that you consider important.

To be up to + object pronoun – it's your decision.

'It's up to her which restaurant we go to. It's her birthday.'

To be worth + gerund – to have enough value that it is worth your time and energy.

Better late than never – better to do something late than not to do it at all.

To make sense – to be intelligent, justifiable or practical.

Out of the blue – suddenly and unexpectedly.

To ring a bell – to say that something sounds or is familiar.

Advanced

To be on the ball – to be ready to take action.

To cost an arm and a leg – to be very expensive.

To be a craze – to be the latest fashionable thing.

To go crazy, mad, nuts – to ‘become’ temporarily crazy for something.

To happen once in a blue moon – something that happens rarely.

To hit the nail on the head – to agree that a comment is exactly right.

To know somewhere like the back of your hand – to be very familiar with a place.

There is no such thing as a free lunch – nothing is entirely free.

Conversation starters

- Tell us something that has happened recently out of the blue.
- Is it still worth going to university?
- What are you looking forward to doing next summer?
- Is turning 21 a big deal in your culture? What age is a big deal?
- Is the saying ‘*There is no such thing as a free lunch*’ true in your experience?

Ways to describe good times

To have a good laugh/ a ball/ a blast/ a whale of a time – to have a good

time.

So far so good – things are going well so far.

Time flies when you're having fun – time passes quickly during good times.

The best of both worlds – the benefits of two different situations enjoyed at the same time.

Ways to describe bad times

To be awful – to be very bad.

To be fed up/ to be sick and tired of something – negative feelings about something.

To be a nightmare – to have a terrible time.

To drive someone crazy – to provoke someone with something.

The good stuff: bad times

To add insult to injury – to make a bad situation worse.

To be a hassle – to be very inconvenient.

To go down well/badly – something has been received well or badly.

To be a bitter pill to swallow – to receive bad news.

To be a pain in the neck – to describe a task that is very annoying.

To be a perfect storm – the worst possible situation.

Telling stories

To be a long story – the story is too long and the person doesn't want to talk about it.

To cut a long story short – in summary.

To cut to the chase – to get to the best part of the story quickly.

To end up + gerund/noun – the unexpected ending to a story.

To turn out + infinitive – the twist in your story.

Talking about luck and probability

Break a leg! – phrase to wish someone luck.

Fingers crossed – to try to influence chance by crossing your fingers.

A stroke of luck – a 'hit' of luck.

Touch wood – to try to influence chance by touching something wooden.

The luck of the draw – a random occurrence of luck or to be picked for something by chance.

Advanced

To dream on – keep dreaming because it won't happen.

No chance – no possibility

A spell (or 'run') of good or bad luck – to pass through a lucky or unlucky time.

When pigs fly/ when hell freezes over – there is no possibility that something will happen.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about a holiday or trip that went really badly.
- When was the last time you had a blast?
- Tell us about a time when you or a friend ended up in hospital.
- Tell us about a time when you had an incredible stroke of luck.
- Have you ever had a spell of good or bad luck? Tell us about it.
- Are you superstitious? What do you do to influence luck ?

Telling jokes

To have a good sense of humour – to see the funny side of life.

To laugh with someone – positive (to share a joke with someone)

To laugh at someone/to make fun of someone – negative (to make someone the object of a joke).

To be kidding/ to pull someone's leg – to joke with someone.

To joke around – to pass the time with friends having a laugh.

The punchline – the final line of the joke when you hope the audience will laugh.

When you're not in the mood for humour

Don't be silly.

To be not in the mood

'Don't be silly. I am not in the mood for jokes today.'

Conversation starters

- Everyone seems to think that they have a good sense of humour. Is this true in your experience?
- Have you ever told someone something that wasn't true to kid them?
- Can you tell us a funny story?
- Is it acceptable to make fun of public figures in your culture? Can you give us an example?

Giving and receiving advice

Brainstorm ways to advise people such as:

- To advise (verb) + object + infinitive.
- Advice (uncountable noun)
- To give some advice.
- To take advice

The good stuff: advice

If I were you + would + infinitive – to put yourself in the position of someone else.

‘If I were you, I would hold out for a better offer.’

If I were in your shoes – another way to say the above phrase.

Good things come to those who wait – be patient.

To live and learn – to learn from your mistakes.

To warn – to alert.

To give/issue a warning – to alert with a noun.

To take something onboard – to accept someone’s advice or ideas.

When you don’t want advice

To stop being nosy – to ask someone not to intrude into your life (informal).

To be none of someone’s business – a confrontational way to say *‘Don’t intrude.’*

To not get involved in someone's business – to say that you don't want to involve yourself in someone else's issues.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about the best advice you have ever received.
- What advice would you give a friend in the below situations?
 - A manager is disrespecting them at work in front of others. Your friend suspects that it is bullying.
 - After years as a couch potato, your friend wants to get back into shape.
 - Your friend likes someone they work with in a romantic way but they are worried about asking a co-worker out on a date.

12. Describing things

Personality adjectives

There are tons of ways to describe personalities, so be selective in what you teach. Most students will already have some vocabulary here, which you should first activate in a brainstorming session.

Positive personality adjectives

Brainstorm positive personality adjectives such as:

- Ambitious
- Assertive
- Cheerful
- Charming
- Conscientious
- Funny
- Fun
- Kind
- Mature
- Loyal
- Open-minded
- Reliable
- Smart

Positive personality adjectives advanced

Here are some positive personality adjectives that your students may not know.

Chatty, talkative– likes to talk.

Easy-going, laid-back – relaxed.

Outgoing – sociable.

Selfless – someone who does a lot of things for other people.

Sensitive – to feel emotion easily.

Sensible – reliable.

Thoughtful – pensive.

Trustworthy – someone you can trust.

Wise – someone who is intelligent and compassionate due to years of experience.

Negative personality adjectives

Brainstorm common negative personality adjectives such as:

- Arrogant
- Closed-minded
- Disorganised
- Immature
- Insecure
- Insincere
- Vain

Negative personality adjectives advanced

Here are some negative adjectives that your students may not know.

Bossy – domineering, authoritarian.

Forgetful – someone who keeps forgetting things.

Moody – someone whose mood is very changeable.

Stubborn – obstinate, immovable.

Selfish – egotistical, self-centred.

Spoilt – someone (often a child) who has been given everything that they want and are now rude and self-centred.

Conversation starters

- Which personality traits are the best and worse to have in a:
 - Boss

- Life partner
- Parent
- Teacher

- Which personality traits are the best to have in these professions?
 - Politician
 - Nurse
 - Journalist
 - CEO

The good stuff: fun ways to describe people

To be the black sheep – to be someone who is different from their family in an undesirable way.

To be a drama queen – someone who makes a big deal out of small things.

To be a good laugh – someone who is fun to be with.

To be a party animal – someone who loves to party.

To have your feet on the ground – to be realistic.

To have your head in the clouds – to be a dreamer.

To be a couch potato – someone who doesn't do exercise and sits in front of the TV.

To be a chatterbox – someone who talks a lot.

To be down to earth – to be unpretentious.

To be a lucky devil – someone who has a stroke of luck.

Conversation starters

- Have you ever been considered to be the black sheep of your family? Why?
- Who is the biggest party animal you know?
- Was there ever a time in your life when you were a couch potato?
- Having your head in the clouds is always a bad thing. Do you agree or disagree? Discuss.
- Have you ever worked or lived with a drama queen? What was it like?

Appearance adjectives

Now on to appearance. Brainstorm common appearance adjectives and nouns such as:

Bodies

- To have a belly/ paunch
- To be slim
- To be skinny/thin
- To be overweight
- To be muscular/well-built
- To be tall/short/medium in height

Hair

- To have curly hair
- To be bald
- To have blond, brown, black, grey, red hair
- To be a blond, brunette, red-head
- To have straight hair
- To have wavy hair

Hair styles

To have a pony-tail – hair is collected at the back of the head in a ‘tail.’

To have a bun – hair is collected at the back of the head without a ‘tail.’

A fringe (UK) / bangs (US) – the shorter hair at the front of the face.

Skin colours and types

To be brown.

To be black, to be Afro-American.

To be white.

To have freckles – small brown marks on your skin from the sun.

To have pale skin – very white skin.

To have olive skin – darker, Mediterranean skin.

To have rosy cheeks – pink cheeks.

Facial hair

To have a beard – full facial hair.

To be clean-shaven – no facial hair.

To have a goatee – a small beard on your chin and nowhere else.

To have a moustache – a line of hair under your nose.

To have sideburns – hair which starts from your ear and goes down to your jaw.

The good stuff: approximate age

If you don't know how old someone is, you say that:

Someone is in their **early, mid or late** + decade.

'She is in her late-40s.'

Speaking activity: guess the celebrity

Divide your students into pairs. Give each pair a paper with the name of a celebrity or public figure as a character. Tell your students to keep the name a secret.

Next, each student must describe the person on the paper. The other student must guess who it is from the description.

Gestures

Brainstorm common gestures such as:

- To point at
- To shake hands
- To shake your head
- To nod
- To cross your arms
- To roll your eyes
- To shrug
- To blink
- To wink
- To yawn

Conversation practice

- Which of these gestures are common in your culture and what do they mean?
- Which gestures can be considered rude and which are neutral?
- Have you ever yawned during something important, such as an interview?
- Are you a person who uses lots of gestures? Which ones?

13. The physical world

Environment

First, brainstorm words related to climate change such as:

- Atmosphere
- Carbon footprint
- Climate change deniers
- Energy consumption
- Fossil fuels (oil, coal, gas)
- Global warming
- The greenhouse effect
- Ozone layer
- Polar ice caps melting
- To pollute, pollution
- Toxic

Other environmental problems

Car exhaust fumes – the gases that cars emit.

To cut down a forest – to cut down the trees in a forest.

To be overpopulated/ overpopulation – too many people in an area.

To emit harmful gases, emissions – to release gases into the atmosphere.

The good stuff: environment problems advanced

To dispose / to be disposable – one use item.

Domestic waste/household waste– the amount of packaging, excess food and other waste a family produces.

To dump rubbish/ trash – to ‘throw away’ trash in large quantities.

Landfill – a large hole where the local government dumps rubbish.

Oil spillage – a large amount of oil is discharged into the sea by accident.

Water shortage – a scarcity of water.

Solutions

Environmentalist – someone who works to protect the environment.

To clean up – to clean an area.

To preserve – to protect a natural area by prohibiting people from developing it.

To protest, to do a protest – a manifestation.

Recycling, to recycle – to reprocess waste items into something else.

To reuse/ to be reusable – to use again.

The good stuff: environmental solutions vocabulary advanced

To ban – to prohibit.

To combat, to tackle a problem – to fight for a solution to a problem.

To pledge – an official promise made by individuals, governments and organisations.

To reduce, to cut down on – to decrease something.

Animals

An endangered species – a species at the edge of extinction.

To become extinct / to die out – when a species ceases to exist.

Habitat – the natural home or environment of an animal, plant or other organism.

Mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, insects – types of organisms.

To lay an egg – an organism produces an egg.

Wildlife – the life that exists in the natural world.

The good stuff: phrases to talk about problems

To be the tip of the iceberg – the small, visible part of a much larger situation or problem that remains hidden.

To take for granted – to not appreciate something because you think that it will always be there.

To be the hardest hit – to be harshly affected by something.

To rely on something, to be reliant on something – to need something.

Conversation starters

- What can people do personally to limit their carbon emissions?
- Which companies are tackling carbon emissions and which are not doing enough?
- If you were the mayor of your city, what policies would you implement to improve air quality and limit the city's impact on the environment?
- What are your thoughts about the banning of petrol and diesel cars by 2040 in Europe and 2035 in the UK?

Weather

First, brainstorm weather vocabulary such as:

- To be cold, freezing
- Fog (n), to be foggy (adj)
- To forecast (v), a forecast (n)
- To be hot, boiling
- To rain (v), rain (n), rainy (adj)
- To snow (v), snow (n), snowy (adj)
- To be sunny, cloudy, windy
- Thunderstorm, thunder and lightning

The good stuff: extreme weather

Blizzard – snowstorm

Hurricane – a windstorm.

Typhoon – tropical storm.

To flood, a flood – an inundation of water.

Drought – when it doesn't rain for a long time and the land becomes so dry that plants can't grow.

Sandstorm – when sand flies into the air due to high winds.

Conversation starters

- What extreme weather do you get in your country?
- What are the protocols when there is extreme weather such as floods, blizzards and droughts?
- What is your favourite type of winter weather?
- Which is your favourite season? Why?

Landscapes

Brainstorm vocabulary for the natural world such as:

- Beach
- Cove
- Coast
- Cliff
- Desert
- Forest, wood
- Glacier
- Hill
- Ocean
- Lake
- Mountain range
- Meadow
- Peak
- Plain
- River
- Sea
- Stream
- Summit
- Valley

Brainstorm vocabulary for the man-made world such as:

- Bridge
- Castle
- Cathedral
- City centre
- City hall (US), Town hall (UK)
- Church
- Factory
- Farm
- Fountain
- Harbour
- Library
- Market

- Monument
- Port
- Reservoir
- Train station
- Skyscraper
- Stadium
- Village
- Warehouse

Farming and gardening

An allotment – a small patch of land where people grow their own food.

To cultivate – to grow food to eat.

To garden – to grow plants in a garden.

A patch of land – a small piece of land.

An orchard – where fruit trees grow.

To harvest a crop – to collect the food you have cultivated.

To sow a seed – to plant a seed in the ground

To water the plants – to give water to plants, to irrigate.

The good stuff: gardening

To have green fingers – phrase meaning that someone is good at making plants grow.

To grow greens – phrase meaning ‘to grow vegetables.’

Conversation starters

- Describe your favourite natural space? What makes it so special?
- Could you live ‘the simple’ life in a cabin in the woods or the mountains? How would you manage it?
- What are your favourite parts of your city and why?
- What does your city ‘get right’ do you think? What does it ‘get

wrong’?

- What gives the population of a city a good quality of life? Good public transport, leisure facilities, green spaces, lots of parking?

Water

You'd be amazed how much vocabulary we use to describe water.

First, brainstorm common water vocabulary such as:

- To boil
- To flow
- To freeze
- To melt
- To spill
- To turn into steam
- To turn to ice

Bathing

Brainstorm bath vocabulary such as:

- Bath
- Bath plug
- To have a bath/ to bathe
- Pipes
- Sink
- Tap

More water vocabulary

To burst, a burst – when a water pipe breaks, causing a large water leakage.

To be damp – to be slightly wet.

To drain – when water disappears down a tube.

'The water in the bath drains.'

To drip, a drip – a leak with small drops of water.

To leak, leakage – water escapes from a tube or enters through a window.

To run a bath – to fill a bath with water.

To overflow – when the water in the river rises and then goes over the border.

To soak, to be soaked/soaking– to be saturated with water.

‘I dropped the towel in the bath and now it is soaked.’

Rain

Lots of text books teach *‘It’s raining cats and dogs.’* I avoid this phrase as it is no longer used in speech. Instead, I teach, *‘It’s pouring’* and other common phrases.

To be waterlogged – when the ground is saturated with water.

To divert a river – to redirect a river.

To flood– inundation of water.

High-water mark – when a river reaches its fullest.

A flash flood – a sudden, dangerous inundation of water.

To pour – heavy rain.

A puddle– a small quantity of water after rain.

To splash – to cover someone with water by accident or for a joke.

Waterproof – to be impermeable.

Wellington boots (wellies) – rubber boots for wearing in the rain.

Conversation starters

- Tell us about a serious plumbing problem that you, a friend or a family member have had?
- Does your region suffer from floods? Tell us about them.
- Did you use to like splashing in muddy puddles as a child?
- Do you still get lots of snow in your country in winter? How long before it melts?

Fire

You can't study water without also mentioning fire.

First, brainstorm fire vocabulary such as:

- To burn
- Campfire
- Chimney
- Fireplace
- A fire
- A flame
- A lighter
- Logs
- Matches

More fire vocabulary

Arson, arsonist – to illegally start a fire.

A blaze (n), **blazing** (adj) – a huge uncontrolled fire.

To catch fire – to ignite a fire.

Forest fire – an uncontrolled fire in a forest.

To glow – the warm light from a fire.

'The campfire glowed in the moonlight.'

To light a fire (light, lit, lit) – to start a domestic or small fire.

To set fire to something – to destroy something by burning it.

A spark – the 'flash' of fire which starts a larger fire (often used figuratively).

To put out a fire / to extinguish a fire.

Conversation starters

- Does your region suffer from forest fires? How do fire-fighters

put them out?

- Children should be allowed to experiment with fire to teach them about the associated risks. Agree or disagree?
- Has there ever been a blaze in your city? How did the building catch fire?

14. Society and economy

Economy

This vocabulary is essential for students who want to work in business and it is also useful for anyone who wishes to take the C1 exam.

First, brainstorm economy vocabulary such as:

- Budget
- Currency
- Deficit
- Deflation
- Economist (person)
- GDP (gross domestic product)
- Interest rates
- Inflation

Other economics vocabulary

Austerity – government cuts to public services to reduce the public debt.

Fiscal policy or **fiscal year** – financial policy, particularly related to taxes.

Macroeconomics – the study of economics at the national level.

Microeconomics – the study of the economic issues of businesses and people and the way that particular parts of the economy behave.

Supply and demand – the amount of people who want a product compared to the amount of product that there is.

The good stuff: the financial crisis of 2008- 11

To bailout, to receive a bailout – the act of giving financial assistance to a failing business or economy to save it from collapse.

Boom and bust economics – a period of rapid economic growth that is

abruptly followed by one of economic decline.

To go bankrupt –a country or business that collapses due to a lack of money.

Recession, a downturn –the economy contracts for two quarters or more.

Conversation practice

- What are the pros and cons of giving banks a bailout?
- Tell us of a product where the demand is stronger than the supply in your country?
- How did your government deal with the last financial crisis? Do you agree with their policies?
- Give us an example of boom and bust economics?

Crime and justice

When teaching crime, vocabulary always covers that ‘to rob’ is for a person or location and that ‘to steal’ is for an object (to steal, stole, stolen). For example, ‘*the thief robbed the bank and stole the money.*’

First, brainstorm crimes and criminals such as:

- To burgle, burglary, a burglar
- To kidnap, kidnapping, a kidnapper
- To murder, a murder, murderer
- To pickpocket, pick-pocketing, a pickpocket
- To rob, robbery, robber
- To shoplift, shoplifting, a shoplifter

Other crimes

A hit and run – to run over a pedestrian and flee the scene.

Manslaughter – to kill someone accidentally.

Speeding – going too fast in a car.

Conversation practice

- Is speeding a crime, in your opinion?
- Have you ever been a victim of pick-pocketing? Tell us what happened.
- Have you ever seen a shoplifter stealing something from a shop? Did you do anything?

Money crimes

There is so much crime vocabulary in English that it is a good idea to devote a separate lesson to money crimes. This could be useful for students who work in finance.

First, brainstorm common money crimes and criminals such as:

- To bribe/ bribery
- To blackmail, blackmailer
- To defraud/ to commit fraud, fraudster
- To launder money/money laundering

Money crimes advanced vocabulary

To embezzle/ embezzlement – to steal funds belonging to one's employer.

To forge something/ to counterfeit something – to make a copy of something valuable in order for people to believe it is real.

Forgery/ counterfeiting (n), forger/ counterfeiters (people)

To ransom/ a ransom – a sum of money demanded or paid for the release of a captive.

White-collar crime – non-violent crimes that take place in companies involving money such as embezzlement and fraud.

Homework assignment

Research a famous criminal case involving a non-violent crime such as embezzlement, fraud, forgery or money laundering that occurred in your country or another. Prepare a presentation to tell the class about it for the next lesson.

The good stuff: criminal actions and the victims of money crime

To fall for something – to believe that something that is a trick or a lie is

true.

To rig/ to be rigged – to manage or conduct something fraudulently in order to gain an advantage.

To rip off (v) to be ripped off (adj) – to pay too much money for something.

To scam someone, a scam, a scammer – a dishonest scheme; a fraud.

Conversation starters

- Should white-collar crime be treated more leniently than violent crime? Why/ why not?
- Have you, or anyone you know, fallen for a scam?
- Have you ever received a counterfeit note? Were you angry?
- What was the last thing that you bought or subscribed to which you now think was a rip off?

Internet crimes

Hacking

To bypass – to go past or to go around.

To crack a password – to discover a password by trying lots of variations.

To do something by trial and error – to experiment with various methods of doing something until one finds the most successful method.

To hack into a computer system/ to be hacked into/ a hack – to break into a computer system.

Hacker – a person who engages in hacking.

Ethical hacker – a person who hacks into a computer network in order to test or evaluate its security rather than with malicious or criminal intent.

A hacktivist – someone who uses their hacking skills for political purposes.

Conversation practice

- What precautions do you take against hackers?
- Do you think that hackers could crack your email password?
- Tell us about something that you have learned through trial and error.

Justice

To be/get caught – when the police or someone else catch a criminal.

To prosecute someone – to conduct legal proceedings against a person or organisation.

To sue someone/ to take someone to court – to institute legal proceedings against a person or institution, typically for compensation.

The good stuff: justice

To be caught red-handed – to be caught while committing a crime.

To get away with a crime – to do a crime with impunity because the criminal is not caught or they are found innocent in court when they are guilty.

To go down for a crime – to be found guilty and sentenced for a crime (UK English).

Conversation practice

- Tell us about a time when you were caught red-handed as a child?
- Who gets away with bad behaviour the most in your family?
- Tell us the steps that you need to take in order to sue someone in your country.
- Have you ever been caught speeding?

Politics

Politics is another important C1 exam topic which your students should know in order to debate about current events.

First brainstorm politics vocabulary, such as:

- Democracy
- Dictatorship
- To elect, election
- Left-wing, Socialists
- Liberals
- Right-wing, Conservatives
- Parliament/ Senate/ Congress
- Prime minister/ President
- Politician
- Politics
- Policy
- To vote for someone

More political vocabulary

A bill – a proposed law to be discussed in parliament where it will be amended, passed or dismissed.

A coalition government – a government formed by more than one party.

The electorate – the people who take part in elections to elect politicians.

The incumbent – a person currently holding an official position.

The opposition – the political party or parties opposing the government

To lobby, lobbyist – to seek influence on an issue.

Trade unions – syndicates to represent workers.

The good stuff: elections

Ballot box – the box where you put your vote.

To get a majority – when a political party wins an election by getting the majority of the votes.

A landslide – to win an election with a large majority of votes.

To run for president/ prime minister – to try to get elected for president.

Turnout – the proportion of the population who go to vote in an election.

Conversation starters

- Are many people still a member of a trade union in your country? Why/why not?
- What are the pros and cons of a coalition government?
- When was the last time a party in your country got a landslide? Why did this happen?
- Is the turn out for local elections higher or lower than national ones?

Society

First, brainstorm social groups and states such as:

Classes

- Blue-collar workers
- Middle-class
- To be posh (UK slang meaning 'upper-class')
- Upper-class
- Working-class
- White-collar workers

Ages

- To collect a pension, to be a pensioner (person)
- To be middle-aged
- To be/get old (adj), elderly (n)
- To be retired, retirement
- To be young (adj), youth (n)

Demographics

Fertility rate, birth rate – the number of babies born in a year.

Mortality rate – the number of people who die in a year.

Life expectancy – the average amount of years that a person in a population is expected to live.

To pass away (UK), to pass (US) – 'to die', usually from natural causes.

The good stuff: generations

Baby Boomers – born 1946 - 1964.

Generation X – born 1965 - 1981.

Millennials – born 1982 - 1997.

Generation Z – born 1998 - 2017.

Housing issues

To be homeless/ homelessness (noun) – to not have anywhere to live.

Housing bubble – when the price of houses becomes artificially inflated.

A housing crash – when the price of houses suddenly decreases dramatically.

To be unaffordable – to be too expensive.

The good stuff: housing

To get on the housing ladder – to buy your first property.

Over-crowding – too many people living together.

To save up for a deposit on a house – the money to finance a mortgage.

Subprime mortgage – a mortgage issued to borrowers with a low credit rating.

Conversation starters

- What is the effect of a low fertility rate for countries?
- Has your country suffered from a housing crash in the 21st century? Tell us about it.
- Do you notice a difference between Millennials and Baby Boomers? What about Millennials and Gen Z?
- What are the typical steps to getting on the housing ladder?

Birth and death

Birth

To be born – adjective for birth.

To give birth – act of delivering a baby.

To take maternity/paternity leave – to take time off after having a baby.

To breastfeed – to give a baby milk from a woman's body.

To be expecting a baby – to be waiting to give birth.

To be due (adj), **a due date** (n) – the date when the mother expects the birth.

Death

To die (v), **death** (n).

To have a near-death experience – to nearly die but live to tell the tale.

To mourn someone – to feel sad when someone dies.

To be in mourning – the period when friends and family feel sad.

To pass away (UK), **to pass** (US) – a more polite way to say 'to die', usually from natural causes.

Funerals

To bury someone (v)/ **burial** (n) – ceremony, putting the deceased person in the ground.

Cemetery – resting place for the dead.

To cremate someone/ to have a cremation – to burn the deceased person.

Coffin – the box in which a person is buried.

To dig a grave (dig, dug, dug).

Eulogy – the speech that the priest or family members give during the funeral for the deceased person.

Grave – where a person is buried

Gravestone/ tombstone – marker to say who the person is.

Tomb – a large, grandiose grave.

Urn – where your ashes end up if you are cremated

Wake – the party/ gathering that mourners have before or after a funeral.

Conversation starters

- What are the funeral practices in your country?
- What are the funeral practices in Western countries like the US and the UK?
- Have you ever had a near-death experience? What happened?

15. Practical stuff

Renting a home

First, brainstorm common rental vocabulary such as:

- The estate agent/ realtor
- Flatmates/housemates
- Furnished/ unfurnished/ semi-furnished
- Landlord/landlady
- To move into a house/to move out of a house, a move (noun)
- To rent a house, flat or apartment
- To search for a house in the property listings
- Tenant

The good stuff: renting a house

To let a house or flat – synonym of ‘to rent.’

Household/domestic appliances – smaller appliances like the vacuum cleaner, kettle or toaster.

White goods – large domestic appliances such as a fridge, freezer or washing machine.

Utility bills – your heating, electricity or water bill.

To be handy – to have the ability to repair or make objects.

To have green fingers – to be good at cultivating plants.

Contracts

The deposit – money that you give the owner in case of a breakage.

To draw up a contract (to draw, drew, drawn) – to create a contract.

Tenancy contract – the paper agreement to rent a house.

People who fix household problems

- A handyman
- A plumber
- An electrician
- A heating engineer

Conversation starters

- Tell us all of the steps involved in renting a house in your country from saving up a deposit to moving in.
- What rights do tenants have in your country? Have you ever rented in another country? What differences did you notice?
- Are you handy? What can you fix?
- Tell us about a good or bad story from renting?

Housework

Housework often uses the verb 'to do.' For example: to do the cleaning, 'washing up, laundry. The exception is 'to make the bed'.

Brainstorm housework vocabulary such as:

- A chore
- To do the laundry
- To do the washing
- To dust
- To make the bed
- To mop
- To polish
- To sweep (sweep, swept, swept)
- To vacuum clean
- To wash up
- To wipe

Conversation starters

- What is your least favourite chore? Which ones are you OK with?
- What do you do to minimise the chores around the house?
- What domestic appliance could you not live without? Which is a waste of time to you?

Money and banks

The main confusion with money vocabulary comes from the difference between 'to lend' and 'to borrow.' To borrow means to 'take' money (or something else) from someone or a bank and then pay or give it back. 'To lend' means to 'give' money (or something else) to someone temporarily. You expect to get it back.

First, brainstorm common money terms such as:

- Bank account
- To borrow
- Debt /det/, to be in debt
- To lend (to lend, lent, lent)
- Interest rate
- To invest, to make an investment
- To owe
- To pay off/ to pay back a loan
- To save, (v) savings (n)
- To save up for something (in particular)
- To take out a loan
- Stocks and shares, shareholder (person)

More money vocabulary

Bank statement – the list of transactions from a bank.

A payslip – paper given to an employee, showing their salary and any taxes deducted.

Instalments (UK) installments (US) – small, regular payments to pay back money to a bank or another organisation.

To take out a mortgage /morgag/ – to borrow an amount of money from a bank to buy a house.

Salaries

A pay rise (UK), a pay raise (US) – when your salary increases.

A bonus – an extra amount of money for performing well at your job.

Wages vs. salary – ‘wages’ are calculated by the hour and a ‘salary’ is calculated by the month. Generally, wages are paid to people in lower paid jobs and salaries are paid to professionals.

Financial problems

To be able to afford something – to have the money to buy something.

To be broke – to lack money temporarily.

To go broke – to have a personal financial disaster.

To go bankrupt – when a company runs out of money and has to close.

The good stuff: family finances

To be frugal/thrifty – to be careful with money.

Breadwinner – the main earner in a family.

To inherit, inheritance – to gain money or another asset upon another person’s death.

Income – the total sum of money you receive on monthly or annual basis including your salary, interest on savings and investments.

To make ends meet – to have enough money to get to the end of the month.

Outgoings – the total sum of money spent on a monthly or annual basis.

Pocket money – small amounts of money paid to children.

To save for a rainy day – to save in case there are bad times in the future.

Conversation starters

- Tell us all of the steps to taking out a loan from setting up a bank account through to signing the loan agreement.
- How much pocket money did you use to get as a child? What is

an acceptable amount do you think?

- What are the pros and cons of having a minimum wage for an economy?
- Is it common to pay for something in instalments in your country? For which products and why?

Cars

Brainstorm parts of a car such as:

- Bonnet (UK)/ hood (US)
- Boot (UK)/ trunk (US)
- Bumper
- Fog lights
- Gear stick
- Hand break
- Headlights
- Steering wheel
- Tires (US)/tyres (UK)
- Tail-lights
- Windscreen
- Windscreen wipers
- Wing mirror

Car problems

To break down – when a machine (car in this case) ceases to work.

To bump into something – a non-serious impact.

To crash – a serious impact.

A flat tyre /tire – a deflated tyre due to a puncture.

A tow truck – the truck that removes a car from the road during a breakdown.

The good stuff: advanced car problems

A crack in the windscreen – a small line-like break in the glass.

A dent in the bodywork/ to dent the bodywork – an indentation after a crash.

A scratch in the paintwork/ to scratch the paintwork – a line or mark in the paint of a car.

Fines and paperwork

To be roadworthy – whether the car is in a fit condition to drive.

To fine someone (v) – a monetary punishment after a driving offence.

To get caught speeding – to be caught driving too fast.

To get a speeding ticket – to receive a fine for driving too fast.

To get a parking fine – to receive a fine for parking in the wrong place.

Hiring a car

To hire a car – to rent a car.

To take a deposit – money given to the hire car company to cover the cost of any damage or fuel used.

Insurance

To be covered by insurance – to not pay for damage because you have an insurance contract for your property.

To claim on insurance – to ask the insurance company to compensate you for an accident.

The excess – the amount you must pay yourself for the damage before you are compensated by the insurance company.

Conversation starters

- Have you ever had a car break down? Tell us about it.
- Is your city strict on speeding? What do they do to limit car speeds?
- Do you know how to fix a flat tyre? Tell us the steps.

- Do scratches and dents in your car worry you? How did you get the marks on your car?
- Have you ever been treated unfairly by a car hire company? What happened?

About the Author

Hello there! My name is Andromeda and I am a writer and online English teacher.

I am the author of The Ultimate ESL Teaching Manual, The Ultimate Teaching ESL Online Manual and now the Ultimate ESL Vocabulary Manual.

I am an advocate for teaching English through oral drills and conversation exercises rather than text-books.

Teaching through oral drills is a powerful tool that requires no materials from the tutor, only your voice. In this way, every class is new and exciting with content tailor-made to your students' needs, driven by speaking activities.

When I'm not teaching or writing, I like to spend time with my husband and two kids hiking in the mountains of Scotland.

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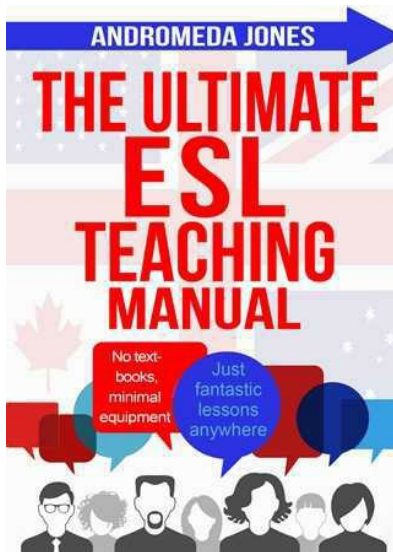
'What a great book! Andromeda's knowledge and experience shines through. She gets straight to the point, gives very clear grammar explanations and offers loads of practical help' Sheila Longden, Amazon.co.uk



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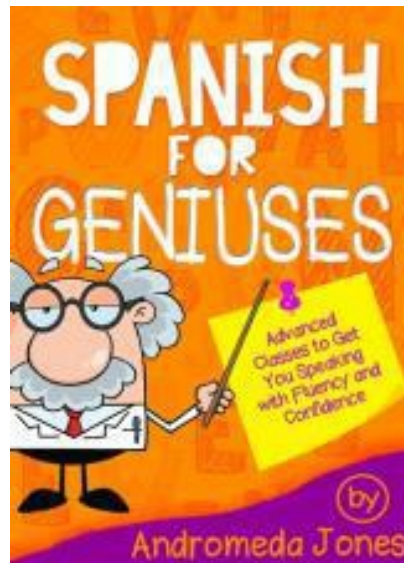
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I have really enjoyed using this book to refresh myself on the grammar fundamentals. However, the really good thing about it is the simple way that it teaches you more typical everyday words and phrases. This is so much more useful than the usual language book formats and it gives a lot of help

with those in-between words that help the conversation flow more naturally.

